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SC to decide if legislative privilege overrides free speech

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 13

The Supreme Court will begin substantive hearing on October 6 on a long-pending constitutional dispute over the limits of legislative privilege and its relationship with the fundamental right to freedom of speech and expression. A seven-judge Constitution Bench will examine whether privileges granted to state legislators under Article 194 can override Article 19(1)(a), and whether such privileges can be used against citizens, including journalists, over publications alleged to breach the privilege of a House.

The case, *N Ravi v. Speaker, Legislative Assembly Chennai*, stems from a dispute involving *The Hindu* in Tamil Nadu in 2003. In April that year, the newspaper published an editorial titled “Rising Intolerance”, criticising then Chief Minister J Jayalalithaa and her government. The Assembly later accused the

CONTINUED ON P4

PRODUCTIVITY AMONG LOWEST

Parl Monsoon Session ends after bitter deadlock and near washout

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 13

The Monsoon Session of Parliament, which concluded on Thursday, was marked by frequent disruptions, shortened sessions, protests and turned out to be a near washout in terms of debates and curtailed business of both Houses.

While the Lok Sabha functioned for only 15 per cent of the scheduled time, the Rajya Sabha for 33 per cent during the 25-day session, according to data released by a leading think tank. Both Houses convened for 19 days; however, consistent adjournments impacted negatively on the regular work of the Parliament.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju, however, said the productivity of the Lok Sabha during the Monsoon session was 19 per cent and that of



Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Union Ministers Amit Shah, Nitin Gadkari, Rajnath Singh and other MPs stand at attention during the rendition of ‘Vande Mataram’ in Lok Sabha

the Rajya Sabha 39 per cent. The government squarely put the blame on the Opposition, mainly the Congress, while the other side held the ruling dispensation responsible for the session-long dead-

lock. The Opposition said it was “unprecedented” that neither the prime minister nor the home minister attended the proceedings even once.

As many as 12 bills were passed each in Lok Sabha and

KEY POINTS

- » Both Houses held 19 sittings
- » Lok Sabha productivity stood at 19%
- » Rajya Sabha productivity stood at 39%
- » Government blamed Congress for disruptions
- » Opposition blamed government for the deadlock
- » Parliament passed 12 Bills
- » Only one Bill saw debate in both Houses
- » Paper-leak legislation was among key Bills passed

Rajya Sabha during the session, but only one -- the Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 or anti-paper leak legislation -- saw discussions in both Houses.

CONTINUED ON P4

SAD chief Badal injured in ‘kirpan’ attack in Maha

Party demands CBI probe

MPOST BUREAU
Nanded, August 13

Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) chief Sukhbir Singh Badal was injured after a member of the Nihang order attacked him with a kirpan inside a gurdwara near Maharashtra’s Nanded on Thursday, police said. The incident took place around 1.45 pm at Gurdwara Mata Sahib Devan Ji Mugat, about 15 km from Nanded.

Badal, 64, was taken to a hospital after suffering an injury to his right hand and received two to three stitches. Visuals showed him walking inside the hospital with his injured hand covered with a cloth. The SAD said his condition was stable and that he was in “chardi kala”, or high spirits.

Nanded Superintendent of Police Neelabh Rohan said the attacker, identified as 60 to 62-year-old Jaspal



HIGHLIGHTS

- » Attack took place around 1.45 pm at Gurdwara Mata Sahib Devan Ji Mugat
- » Gurdwara is located about 15 km from Nanded town
- » Badal suffered an injury to his right hand
- » He received two to three stitches at a hospital
- » Nihang member Jaspal Singh, 60-62, arrested after the attack

Singh, was arrested at the spot. “A Nihang attacked Badal with a kirpan inside the gurdwara.”

CONTINUED ON P4

Briefs

Air India to test all pilots for drugs

NEW DELHI: Air India and Air India Express will introduce mandatory psychoactive substance tests for all their pilots from Thursday, going beyond the regulatory requirement to randomly screen at least 10 per cent of flight crew each year.

The move follows an August 4 incident involving Air India flight AI2379, an Airbus A320neo

CONTINUED ON P4

NHAI sets 10-minute ambulance response

NEW DELHI: The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) has set a 10-minute response deadline for ambulances to reach accident sites within a 10-km radius, with a penalty of Rs 10,000 for each delay. The new norms are part of measures to strengthen the Incident Management System through the NHAI Care System.

CONTINUED ON P4

TMC to move SC against 20 rebel MPs

KOLKATA: The Trinamool Congress is preparing to move the Supreme Court seeking the disqualification of 20 Lok Sabha MPs who have broken away from the party and joined the Nationalist Citizens’ Party of India (NCPI), party sources said on Thursday in Parliament.

CONTINUED ON P4

CJI INVITE ROW

BCI reverses bar on NALSAR graduates after backlash

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 13

The Bar Council of India (BCI) on Thursday withdrew its direction barring state bar councils from enrolling 2026 graduates of NALSAR University of Law as advocates, hours after the order triggered widespread criticism on social media.

The BCI had initially directed all state bar councils to withhold the enrolment of the Hyderabad-based university’s 2026 graduates until further orders. BCI chairman Manan Kumar Mishra said the decision followed allegations surrounding a campaign against Chief Justice of India Surya Kant’s proposed

CONTINUED ON P4

No tip before trip, govt to ride-hailing apps

New Delhi, August 13

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) has directed motor vehicle aggregators to remove all prompts encouraging passengers to tip before or during a cab ride, saying such options cannot be linked to ride confirmation, driver acceptance, allocation, waiting time or service quality. The directive, issued on

CONTINUED ON P4

6 DEAD IN CHAMOLI TUNNEL ACCIDENT



People gather after a landslide in an under-construction tunnel of the Vishnugad-Pipalkoti Hydroelectric Project, in Chamoli district, Uttarakhand, on Thursday

REPORT ON P4

‘Last chance’: SC warns Centre over delay in food warning labels

Labels concern packaged foods high in sugar, salt and saturated fats

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 13

The Supreme Court on Thursday gave the Centre two weeks to take a final decision on front-of-pack warning labels for packaged foods high in sugar, salt and saturated fat, warning that it would issue directions if the government failed to act. A bench of Justices JB Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran questioned the Centre and the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) over the delay, say-

ANCHOR HIGHLIGHTS

1. Bench warns it will issue directions if government fails to act
2. “This is your last chance,” the bench told the Centre
3. Court said it could “dictate the judgment” at the next hearing
4. Centre argued international nutritional standards may not suit Indian dietary patterns
5. Judges said warning labels would inform consumers, not stop product sales



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ing the matter involved public health, particularly that of children.

“This is your last chance. Next time we will dictate the judgment,” the bench said, making it clear that the

CONTINUED ON P4



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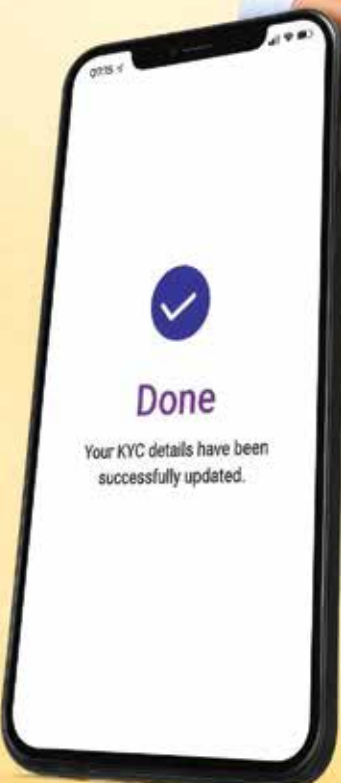


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Murder accused with 118 cases nabbed after police encounter

Jahangir Puri ‘Bad Character’ snatches pistol, opens fire

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 13

The Delhi Police Special Staff has arrested a 29-year-old habitual criminal wanted in a daylight murder case in Jahangir Puri after he allegedly snatched a police constable's service pistol and opened fire at a police team while being brought to Delhi on transit remand.

The accused, identified as Waseem Akram alias Lambu, a resident of Jahangir Puri, was arrested in Nandigram, West Bengal, following a tip-off received by the Special Staff.

According to police, Akram has 118 criminal cases registered against him, including murder, attempt to murder, burglary, theft, offences under the Arms Act and POCSO-related charges. He is also listed as a ‘Bad Character’ at Jahangir Puri police station.

The incident took place



around midnight on the intervening night of August 11 and 12, when a police team was bringing Akram back to Delhi from Nandigram after securing his transit remand.

Police said Akram repeatedly asked the team to stop the vehicle, citing different reasons and claiming that he wanted to relieve himself. When the vehicle was stopped on the Yamuna Expressway within Mathura police jurisdiction, he allegedly snatched the 9mm service pistol of Head Constable Harish and fled.

The police team chased him and repeatedly asked

TAKEAWAYS

The police team chased him and repeatedly asked him to surrender. However, Akram allegedly opened fire, hitting Sub-Inspector Ajay Kumar in the left arm. Akram then turned towards HC Narsi Ram while holding the pistol, Narsi Ram fired at him in self-defence

him to surrender. However, Akram allegedly opened fire, hitting Sub-Inspector Ajay Kumar in the left arm. When Akram then turned towards Head Constable Narsi Ram while holding the pistol, Narsi Ram fired at him in self-defence, hitting him in the right leg.

Both Ajay Kumar and Akram were taken to hospital for treatment.

“My focus was on ensuring the safety of my team members”: Cops narrate encounter

Recalling the incident, SI Ajay Kumar said Akram had repeatedly asked the police to stop the vehicle

while they were travelling from Nandigram to Delhi.

“He used to ask for stopping the vehicle on many occasions, one pretext or the other. He had some motive,” Ajay said.

“As soon as we stopped the vehicle, he took out the service pistol of HC Harish and started firing. When he fired, it hit me on my left arm,” he added.

HC Narsi Ram said he opened fire after Akram refused to surrender and pointed a pistol, prioritising his team's safety. Akram, wanted in Irfan's murder, has 118 cases and is listed as a ‘Bad Character’.

JNU recruitment: Students bodies allege illegalities and demand VC's removal, probe

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 13

The Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) and Teachers' Association (JNUTA) have demanded the removal of Vice-Chancellor Santishree Dhulipudi Pandit and an independent, time-bound inquiry into alleged irregularities in faculty recruitment and promotions.

Citing recent media reports, the two bodies alleged that candidates rejected by screening committees were later reinstated by the Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC) despite not meeting UGC norms. JNUTA claimed at least seven appointments violated regulations and accused the administration of bypassing statutory procedures.

The organisations sought a judicial or Visitorial inquiry, preservation of recruitment records, disclosure of appointment documents and action against officials found responsible.

DUSU POLLS SEPT 18

Campus power struggle ahead

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 13

Student organisations at Delhi University are gearing up for another year of campus politics with the university announcing September 18 as the date for the DUSU elections, setting the stage for contests between major groups including the ABVP, NSUI, SFI and AISA.

The polling for the 2026-27 academic session will be held on September 18, and the counting of votes will take place on the same day, according to a notification issued by the university on Thursday.

The last date for filing nomination papers has been fixed as September 10. Candidates can submit their papers, along with a Rs 500 demand draft and affidavits, till 3 pm that day. Scrutiny will be held at 3:15 pm, followed by publication of the list of duly nominated candidates by 6 pm.

Candidates can withdraw their nominations till noon on September 11,

LAST DATE FOR FILING NOMINATION PAPERS HAS BEEN FIXED AS SEPT 10

while the final list will be published by 5 pm.

Students attending day classes will vote between 8:30 am and 1 pm, while those attending evening classes will vote from 3 pm to 7:30 pm.

The university had earlier appointed Raj Kishore Sharma from the Department of Chemistry as the chief election officer and librarian Rajesh Singh as the chief returning officer for the 2026-27 polls.

The appointments, notified on August 5, marked the beginning of preparations for the annual elections.

DUSU polls will be held on September 18, with student groups preparing candidates and campaigns. Last year, ABVP won three of four central panel posts.

Briefs

Five held for staging crash to kill man

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have arrested five men, including alleged mastermind Pawan alias Jagpal Dabas, for killing 30-year-old Deepak by staging a road accident.

Police said Pawan had a prior rivalry with Deepak and orchestrated multiple attempts to kill him.

The accused allegedly rammed Deepak's scooter with a car before killing him in a Scorpio on July 16, in an elaborate plot aimed at concealing the murder as an accident and misleading investigators.

2 arrested in e-SIM fraud

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has busted an interstate cyber-fraud module allegedly involved in e-SIM takeovers and arrested two key operatives from West Bengal, recovering 44 mobile phones, officers said on Thursday.

Ankit Das and cousin Subal Das are linked to 124 cyber-crime complaints, police said. They allegedly posed as telecom employees to carry out e-SIM takeovers, accessing OTPs and banking communications. Ankit was earlier booked in Faridabad.

Home guard killed in Ghaziabad

DIPIKA KIROLA
Ghaziabad, August 13

A 40-year-old home guard was killed and a police constable injured after a speeding Thar allegedly rammed into their PRV motorcycle from behind on NH-9 in Ghaziabad late Wednesday night. Police arrested the SUV driver, identified as cloth trader

Sonu Gulati, who was allegedly driving under the influence of alcohol.

The accident occurred around 11pm when PRV-9619, deployed in Noida, was responding to an emergency call from the 112 helpline. The personnel were travelling towards Gaur City-2 in Biskh when they entered the Ghaziabad stretch

of NH-9 to take a U-turn towards Delhi.

The Thar allegedly hit the motorcycle at high speed, throwing both personnel off the vehicle. Home guard Kapil Kumar, a resident of Hapur, died at the spot, while constable Praveen was injured and later discharged from hospital. Police arrested Gulati and seized the vehicle.

ASSAM WOMAN KILLED IN NOIDA PG Postmortem reveals 10 sharp-force injuries

DIPIKA KIROLA
Noida, August 13

A 19-year-old woman from Assam, allegedly murdered inside a paying guest accommodation in Noida's Baraula village, suffered around 10 sharp-force injuries, according to her postmortem report. Police

arrested the alleged killer, Raman Raj, from Katihar in Bihar on Thursday and are bringing him to Noida on transit remand.

The victim, Mehak Ahmed, had arrived in Noida around three weeks ago without informing her parents and was working at a call centre. She lived

with her friend Sanjana in a three-storey PG under Sector 49 police station.

Raman, a BTech graduate and former IT employee, stayed on the same floor.

Police said Mehak and Raman had an argument on August 8, when he was allegedly drink-

ing outside his room. Sanjana returned on August 10 to find Mehak missing, while residents noticed a foul smell from Raman's locked room. Police found Mehak's blood-soaked body inside.

Investigators traced Raman through mobile-location data.

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Growth of 33% in PBT in the current quarter Q1, 2026-27 (Rs 1,514 Cr) over the corresponding quarter Q1, 2025-26 (Rs 1,136 Cr)

Growth of 33% in PAT in the current quarter Q1, 2026-27 (Rs 1,133 Cr) over the corresponding quarter Q1, 2025-26 (Rs 851 Cr)

This is an AI generated image. Not an actual image.

Extract of Un-Audited Financial Results for quarter ended 30th June, 2026

(All amounts are Rupees in crore, unless otherwise stated)

S. No.	Particulars	Standalone				Consolidated			
		Quarter Ended		Year Ended		Quarter Ended		Year Ended	
		30/06/2026	31/03/2026	30/06/2025	31/03/2026	30/06/2026	31/03/2026	30/06/2025	31/03/2026
		Un-audited	Audited	Un-audited	Audited	Un-audited	Audited	Un-audited	Audited
1.	Total income from operations (net)	5,554.14	9,442.09	11,879.86	43,494.91	5,557.84	9,442.09	11,879.86	43,494.91
2.	Net Profit for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	1,514.43	1,794.97	1,136.11	5,157.55	1,490.84	1,794.39	1,109.86	5,123.90
3.	Net Profit for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	1,514.43	1,794.97	1,136.11	5,157.55	1,490.84	1,794.39	1,109.86	5,123.90
4.	Net Profit from ordinary activities after tax	1,132.72	1,338.05	850.58	3,842.67	1,137.14	1,370.74	841.88	3,912.53
5.	Other Comprehensive Income	-	2.36	-	(5.39)	0.01	2.49	-	(5.24)
6.	Total Comprehensive Income	1,132.72	1,340.41	850.58	3,837.28	1,137.15	1,373.23	841.88	3,907.29
7.	Equity share capital	1,500.00	1500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00	1,500.00
8.	Other Equity (excluding revaluation reserve)	-	-	-	20,219.66	-	-	-	20,784.82
Earnings per share (Face value of ₹10/- each)									
9.	a) Basic (₹)	7.55	8.92	5.67	25.62	7.58	9.14	5.61	26.08
	b) Diluted (₹)	7.55	8.92	5.67	25.62	7.58	9.14	5.61	26.08
		(not annualised)				(not annualised)			

Notes:-

1. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at the meeting held on 12th August 2026. The Statutory auditors of the Company have carried out limited review of the aforesaid results.

2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of the Statements of Un-Audited Standalone and Consolidated Financials Results, for the quarter ended 30th June 2026, filed with the stock exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (listing and other disclosure requirements) Regulations' 2015. The full format of the Statements of Un-Audited Standalone and Consolidated Financials results are available on the websites of National Stock Exchange, the Bombay Stock Exchange and the website of the company (www.petronetlng.in).

Place : New Delhi

Date : 12th August 2026

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Email: plsingapore@petronetlng.in

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Saurav Mitra

Director (Finance) & CFO

(Whole-time Director)

DIN: 07684414

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Narela: 2 kids drown in rainwater-filled pit

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE
New Delhi, August 13

Two children, aged nine and 11, died after falling into a rainwater-filled pit in the 100 Feet DDA Flats area of Narela, Delhi, Thursday. The children, who lived in Bawana, had gone there to play when they accidentally fell into the waterlogged pit.

Locals spotted them struggling, pulled them out and alerted police through a PCR call received at NIA police station.

Police and locals rushed them to Satyawadi Raja Harishchandra Hospital in Narela, where doctors declared them dead on arrival. Police have registered an FIR and launched an investigation into the incident.

They are examining how the children accessed the pit and whether safety measures, including barricades, warning tape or signs, had been installed. Locals are also being questioned as authorities investigate whether any entity may be held responsible.

Shop employee ‘tipped off’ robbers in Rs 3.5 lakh heist

‘Live location, gestures helped robbers’

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 13

The Delhi Police have arrested three men and apprehended a juvenile in connection with the robbery of Rs 3.50 lakh from a motorcyclist in Dayalpur, alleging that the victim's shop employee helped orchestrate the crime by sharing his live location and identifying the cash-filled bag.

The incident occurred on August 2, when complainant Ravi Singh Jadon and employee Mohit were travelling on a Splendor motorcycle near Sherpur Chowk. Two masked men on a black TVS Ntorq scooter intercepted them and fled with the bag containing cash and two mobile phones.

Police registered a case under Sections 309(4) and 3(5)

FOUR APPREHENDED; COPS RECOVERED RS 15,000, A MOTORCYCLE AND CLOTHES WORN BY TWO SUSPECTS. FURTHER RECOVERIES AND ONE ARREST ARE PENDING

of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and examined more than 100 CCTV cameras along the suspected escape routes.

Aazan alias Addu alias Suhail, Shehzad alias Fighter, Mohit and a 17-year-old were apprehended. Police recovered Rs 15,000, a motorcycle and clothes worn by two suspects. Further recoveries and one arrest are pending.

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Fresh recruits: A new class of teachers for city schools

CM hands over appointment letters to over 1,300 teachers

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, 13 August

In a major push to strengthen Delhi's government school system and tackle long-standing teacher shortages, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday handed over appointment letters to 1,368 newly recruited teachers, describing the occasion as a step towards securing the future of lakhs of students across the Capital.

At a state-level programme held at Bharat Mandapam, appointment letters were distributed to 1,015 Trained Graduate Teachers (TGTs), 236 Post Graduate Teachers (PGTs) and 117 music teachers. Education Minister Ashish Sood, senior officials of the Directorate of Education and other dignitaries were also present.

Addressing the newly appointed teachers, Gupta said the appointments carried a larger responsibility than simply joining government service. "This is not just an appointment letter, but a responsibility to shape the future of lakhs of children in Delhi," she said.

Calling Delhi "a city of dreams" for people from across the country, the Chief Minister said every child studying in a government school deserves quality education, health-care and opportunities



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta presents an appointment letter to a newly appointed teacher as Education Minister Ashish Sood looks on

FRESH FACES

- » At a state-level programme held at Bharat Mandapam, appointment letters were distributed to 1,015 TGTs, 236 Post Graduate Teachers and 117 music teachers
- » Addressing the newly appointed teachers, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the appointments carried a larger responsibility than simply joining government service
- » This is not just an appointment letter, but a responsibility to shape the future of lakhs of children in Delhi, says CM

for a better future. Highlighting the need for the recruitment drive, Gupta recalled visiting government schools where students told her there were no teachers for subjects such as science and music. In some schools, she said, a handful of teachers had to manage several classes, exposing the seriousness of staff shortages. She added

that the government subsequently worked with the Education Department to address the issue.

The Chief Minister said the government's focus extended beyond creating school infrastructure to ensuring every classroom had qualified teachers, better teaching standards, effective use of technology and greater opportunities

in sports and the arts. She urged the newly recruited teachers to become mentors and role models in addition to being subject experts. Education Minister Ashish Sood said the latest appointments would significantly strengthen Delhi's education system. "Every child will get access to quality education; campaign to address teacher shortages will continue," he said.

Emphasising the government's commitment to filling vacancies, Sood added, "Our goal is clear: wherever a teacher is needed, a teacher should be available; wherever a subject expert is required, there should be a specialist teacher; and every child in Delhi should have an equal opportunity to receive quality education."

CM opens 2-lane bridge in E Delhi



AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, 13 August

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday inaugurated two newly constructed two-lane slip road bridge over the Ghazipur Drain and Hindon Canal at Kondli, aimed at improving connectivity and reducing traffic congestion in East Delhi. Union Minister of State and East Delhi MP Harsh Malhotra, PWD Minister Parvesh Verma, Patparganj MLA Ravinder Singh Negi, Trilokpuri MLA Ravi Kant and senior officials attended the event.

The project is expected to benefit residents of Kondli, Kalyanpuri, Ghazipur, Patparganj and nearby areas by providing smoother traffic movement and reducing pressure on the existing Kondli Bridge. After the inauguration, the Chief Minister inspected the bridges and reviewed the traffic arrangements and infrastructure.

Addressing the gathering, Rekha Gupta said the government is prioritising infrastructure projects that directly benefit citizens by strengthening Delhi's road network, reducing congestion and improving connectivity. She said, "the Kondli project, although approved earlier, had remained pending as required approvals and No Objection Certificates (NOCs) were not secured." According to the Chief Minister, the present government completed the pending formalities, reallocated funds and expedited the project.

She also highlighted the need to modernise Delhi's drainage system, saying inadequate maintenance and desilting of old drains had contributed to recurring waterlogging during the monsoon. The government, she said, is working towards strengthening the drainage network to provide a long-term solution.

34 govt schools face demolition

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 13 August

The Delhi government is set to demolish 34 of its schools to address safety and infrastructure concerns, while constructing 27 new school buildings across the city, an official said.

The new school buildings, being constructed on vacant plots at a cost of around Rs 900 crore, are expected to be completed within 18 months, with the sites divided into five geographical clusters for faster execution and monitoring, the official said.

Of 34 schools identified for demolition, work is underway on 16, while nine cases have been approved. Some of these schools have waterlogging issues, while others have safety concerns or are located at sites considered unsuitable for students, the official said.

The move follows a citywide digital profiling exercise covering all 1,090 government schools to assess their infrastructure and safety requirements, the official said.

He said the profiling has been completed for all 1,090 schools and the education department is now assessing the data to determine the infrastructure improvements required at each school.

Traditional swings, folk songs mark celebrations CM joins 'Teej' at Mayor's home

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, 13 August

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday joined 'Teej' celebrations at Mayor Pravesh Wahi's residence here, which was marked by traditional swings, festive delicacies and folk songs as the city celebrated the monsoon festival.

According to an official

statement, Gupta attended the celebrations at 1 Lancer Road and extended her greetings to women observing the festival.

Mehndi was applied, and bangles were distributed to women at the event, bringing a festive touch to the mayor's residence, the statement read.

The chief minister said folk festivals keep people

connected with their culture and traditions and called for collective efforts to pass them on to the next generation.

She also linked the celebrations with the city's environmental goals, saying, "We wish Hariyali Teej would become an occasion that inspires people to make Delhi greener."

DDA's five-star plan for Dwarka

SHIVANGI SHUKLA
New Delhi, 13 August

The Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has signed an agreement with Juniper Hotels Ltd to develop a 5-star hotel in Sector 23, Dwarka, in a move aimed at strengthening the sub-city's position as an economic, commercial and investment destination. The agreement was signed on August 12 in the presence of DDA Vice Chairman N. Saravana Kumar.

The project, to be developed by Juniper through its subsidiary Juniper Hospitality Assets Private Limited on a licence fee basis, is expected to attract capital investment of more than Rs 1,000 crore and create around 800 direct employment opportunities.

The property will overlook DDA's Dwarka Golf Course and is located near the Yashobhoomi Convention Centre, Dwarka Sports Complex and the proposed Diplomatic Enclave. Its location is expected to strengthen Dwarka's hospitality and tourism ecosystem and cater to business travellers, visitors, tourists, golfers and the proposed Diplomatic Enclave. The project is one of four special licence-fee projects auctioned by DDA over the past year and is the first for which the Authority has formally executed a licensing agreement. The site will soon be handed over to Juniper. Over the 55-year licence period, the hotel is projected to generate more than Rs 6,000 crore in revenue for DDA.

TRICOLOUR GLOW



Visitors walk down the Kartavya Path overlooking the India Gate illuminated in the Indian tricolour ahead of the Independence Day, on Thursday

Twin towers out, Secretariat in

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, 13 August

The Delhi government has finalised plans to construct a new integrated Secretariat at ITO by identifying around 10 acres of land, while simultaneously dropping its earlier proposal to build twin towers. The revised plan envisages a single high-rise administrative complex that will bring together the offices of the Chief Minister, ministers and several key government departments currently functioning from different locations across the capital.

Speaking to *Millennium Post*, Public Works Department (PWD) Minister Parvesh Verma said the government has sought the Centre's approval for the

land required for the project and discussions with the Income Tax Department are progressing.

"We have identified around 10 acres of land at ITO for the new Delhi Secretariat and have sent a proposal to the Centre. The plan is to redevelop the existing Income Tax Office, the MSO Building and adjoining land to construct a modern single-tower Secretariat.

The earlier concept of twin towers has now been replaced with a single integrated building," Verma said. According to the minister, the Income Tax Department will be relocated to a newly developed multi-storey office on the opposite side of the existing building. The overall

redevelopment will cover nearly 18 acres, of which about five acres belong to the Income Tax Department. The department will receive office space in the newly constructed complex in exchange for the land.

The project is intended to address the space constraints faced by the Delhi government. At present, the Chief Minister, cabinet ministers and senior bureaucrats function from the Players Building near the Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, while several departments operate from different offices across the city. The proposed Secretariat aims to consolidate these offices under one roof, improving administrative coordination and reducing operational inefficiencies.

Briefs

Rs 6 cr copper seized from freight train

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Goods and Services Tax (DGST) Department, in a joint operation with railway authorities, has seized around 50 tonnes of copper and two tonnes of aluminium ingots being transported by a freight train without valid documents, e-way bills or invoices. Officials estimated the value of the seized copper at around Rs 6 crore, while the aluminium ingots are worth approximately Rs 4 lakh.

Hog deer found dead at Delhi zoo

NEW DELHI: A hog deer was found dead in a decomposing condition at the National Zoological Park here, authorities on Thursday said. A letter was submitted to the zoo authorities by the employee who was originally on leave of absence seeking a detailed inquiry into the animal's death and alleged lapses in its monitoring.

Delhi govt steps up HIV awareness

NEW DELHI: Health Minister Pankaj Singh said HIV awareness is not only a health issue but also a matter of social responsibility as the Delhi government intensified its awareness, prevention, testing and treatment campaign targeting the infection, officials said on Thursday.

**DELHI POLICE**
SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

**दिल्ली पुलिस**
शांति सेवा न्याय

स्वतंत्रता दिवस - 2026

INDEPENDENCE DAY - 2026

ENTRY

प्रवेश केवल निमंत्रण कार्ड के माध्यम से ही होगा।

ENTRY

Entry is strictly through invitation card only.

⊗

आगंतुकों के लिए निम्नलिखित वस्तुएं वर्जित हैं

FOLLOWING ITEMS ARE PROHIBITED FOR THE INVITEES

⊗

 खाने-पीने की चीजें, केचप, सॉस Eatables, Ketchup, Sauce	 सिगरेट, बीड़ी, लाईटर Cigarettes, Bidi, Lighter
 थैला, ब्रीफकेस, रिमोट नियंत्रित कार लॉक चाबियाँ Bag, Briefcase, Remote Controlled Car Lock Keys	 ज्वलनशील पदार्थ, माचिस, शराब, एरोसोल, जेल/पेस्ट, इत्र, स्प्रे इत्यादि Fuel, Matchbox, Alcohol, Aerosol, Gel/Paste, Perfumes, Spray etc.
 रेडियो, ट्रांजिस्टर, टेपरेकॉर्डर, पेजर Radio, Transistor, Tape Recorder, Pager	 हथौड़े, ड्रिल, आरी, तलवार, कटार, पेंचकस Hammers, Drills, Saws, Sword, Dagger, Screw Driver
 कैमरा, दूरबीन, हैंडिकैम Camera, binoculars, Handycam	 मोबाइल चार्जर, इयरफोन, पावर बैंक, बैटरी Mobile Charger, Earphone, Power Bank, Battery
 थर्मस, पानी की बोतल, कैन, छाता Thermo Flask, Water Bottle, Cans, Umbrella	 रेजर, ब्लेड, चाकू, कैंची, तार, नुकीला हथियार Razors, Blades, Knives, Scissors, Wires, Cutting/Sharp Pointed Edged Material
 पटाखे, बारूद, फ्लेयर्स, किसी भी प्रकार के विस्फोटक Firecrackers, Gunpowder, Flares, Any Type of Explosives	 गोला-बारूद, आग्नेयास्त्र, खिलौना बंदूकें Ammunitions, Firearms, Toy Guns
 डिजिटल डायरियाँ, पाम-टॉप कंप्यूटर, लेपटॉप, डीवीडी / सीडी प्लेयर, डीवीडी / सीडी, आईपैड, आईफोन, टेबलेट, पेनड्राइव Digital Diaries, Palm-top Computer, Laptop, Tablet, DVD/CD Player, DVD/CD, I-Pad, I-Pod, Pendrive	 निष्क्रिय करने वाले रसायन और अन्य खतरनाक वस्तुएं Disabling Chemicals and Other Dangerous Items

यदि कोई लावारिस वस्तु दिखाई दें, तो निकटतम सुरक्षाकर्मी के नोटिस में लाएं

Suspicious objects, if any may be brought to the notice of the nearest Security Personnel

Please co-operate with Police during searching/frisking

Please be alert to your surroundings

कृप्या तलाशी देने में पुलिस के साथ सहयोग करें

कृप्या अपने आस पास नज़र रखें

Email to CP, Delhi at: cpdelhi@delhipolice.gov.in | Write to CP, Delhi at: P.O. Box No. 171, GPO, New Delhi

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FOR IMMEDIATE POLICE HELP, CALL 112

TO SHARE ANTI TERRORIST ACTIVITIES, CALL 14547

DP19899/2026

Chamoli: 6 dead as water, debris enter tunnel

MPOST BUREAU
Dehradun, August 13

Six people died and 14 sustained injuries on Thursday after water and debris entered a tunnel under construction at a hydro-electric project site in Chamoli district of Uttarakhand, officials said.

According to preliminary information shared by the officials, 22 workers were trapped inside the tunnel. Twenty people have been brought out of the tunnel. Of them, six were declared dead, while 14 others have sustained

injuries and are undergoing treatment at a nearby hospital.

Information about the remaining two workers was not immediately available.

The incident occurred at the Tehri Hydro Development Corporation (THDC) Limited's project site in the Pipalkoti area. The construction work is being carried out by the Hindustan Construction Company (HCC), the officials said.

Uttarakhand Chief Secretary Anand Vardhan told PTI earlier that according

to reports, several workers were trapped after water and debris entered the tunnel of the Pipalkoti hydro-electric project.

Police, State Disaster Response Force (SDRF), Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) and other agencies rushed to the spot.

A National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) team from Rudraprayag was on the way to Pipalkoti to join the rescue operation. Indo-Tibetan Border Police and Army teams were also deployed. District Magistrate (DM)

Gaurav Kumar reached the spot and was overseeing the entire operation, officials said.

In a post on X, Chief Minister Dhama expressed concern over the incident and directed all agencies to conduct relief and rescue operations on a war footing.

Vinod Kumar Suman, Secretary of Disaster Management and Rehabilitation Department, said the situation is being continuously monitored from emergency operation centres and additional teams will be deployed if needed.

RBI Governor Malhotra highlights central banks' role in price and financial stability

MPOST BUREAU
Jaipur, August 13

RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said central bank cooperation was vital to maintaining price and financial stability and building a resilient, efficient and inclusive financial system at the BRICS Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors' meeting in Jaipur on August 12-13.

The meeting was co-chaired by Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Malhotra. Accord-

HE APPRECIATED WORK BY CENTRAL BANK GROUPS ON INFORMATION SECURITY, FINTECH & CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS

ing to an RBI social media post on Thursday, Malhotra appreciated work by central bank groups on information security, fintech, cross-border payments, sustainable finance,

capacity building and the Contingent Reserve Arrangement.

Earlier this week, Malhotra said BRICS countries were examining ways to make cross-border payments faster and cheaper. Options under discussion include linking multiple payment systems and using central bank digital currencies (CBDCs), particularly to lower costs for retail transactions.

He said the initiatives were still at the discussion

stage. On trade in local currencies, Malhotra said India already conducts such transactions with several countries, although volumes remain small.

The RBI has signed memoranda of understanding with the central banks of the UAE, Mauritius, Maldives and Indonesia to create awareness among importers and exporters about using local currencies. More such agreements are in the pipeline, he said.

From page 1

Parl Monsoon

According to PRS Legislative Research data, nine bills were passed without discussion, and one was cleared in just two minutes and only two of 380 questions listed for oral answers were responded to. The data underscored the disruption and paralysis that characterised sittings during the session.

The session was largely defined by the Opposition's demand for a statement by Union home minister Amit Shah on the Jantar Mantar crackdown and a series of disruptions over issues such as the alleged theft of Ram temple donations.

While Speaker Om Birla did not read out the usual valedictory address in which he highlights the performance and productivity of the House, Rajya Sabha Chairman CP Radhakrishnan expressed "deep concern" over disruptions that "derailed" the business of the Upper House during the session.

The session witnessed acrimonious scenes and sloganeering by the opposition parties, which led to daily disruption of proceedings in both Houses as the issue of police action against the students' protests and the alleged theft of donations at Ram Temple in Ayodhya reverberated through the four-week period.

In the midst of the session, Dharmendra Pradhan resigned as education minister following mounting pressure from agitating students.

The Question Hour suffered one of the worst performances in parliamentary functioning during the session. Only two out of 380 listed questions in Lok Sabha were answered orally, while 16 out of 285 listed questions in the Rajya Sabha were answered orally.

As per PRS, it was the poorest functioning of the Question Hour since 2019. The Lok Sabha had just one per cent of Question Hour functioning, while the Rajya Sabha had 12 per cent.

One of the other aspects which came up in the analysis of this session of the Monsoon Session was the persistent lack of a Deputy Speaker of the Lok Sabha. As per the Constitution, it is mandatory for the Lok Sabha to elect a Deputy Speaker "as soon as may be".

But the 17th Lok Sabha managed to end its five-year term without having a Deputy Speaker, while the current 18th Lok Sabha, which has been in power for more than two years, still has not elected a Deputy Speaker.

The Congress, the Trinamool Congress, and the Samajwadi Party boycotted the customary tea party hosted by Birla after the House was adjourned sine die. Only DMK leader Kammozhii attended the traditional get-together.

In Rajya Sabha, however, opposition leaders, including Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and former party chief Sonia Gandhi, attended the tea party hosted by the chairman.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, and several other senior leaders and ministers were present at the tea party in the Speaker's chamber.

Parliamentary Affairs Minister Kiren Rijiju blamed the Congress for "unfairly disrupting" House proceedings during the session and said it was for the first time in the country that the opposition was "running away" from a debate when the government wanted discussion.

Blaming the Congress, the minister said the Opposition MPs now seem to think their job is just to raise slogans and create a ruckus while brandishing placards and banners.

The Congress, however, claimed that never before had a government been so "scared and rattled" as this government was during the session, just-concluded session and accused the BJP leadership of "running away" from Parliament.

The Congress also claimed that opposition unity and solidarity were on full display during the entire duration of the session.

Expressing displeasure over the low productivity, Chairman CP Radhakrishnan expressed "deep concern" over the disruptions and disorder that "derailed" the business of the House.

"As the 271st Session of the Rajya Sabha draws to a close, I reflect on its proceedings with deep concern. It is a matter of regret that the session was marked by persistent disorder and frequent disruptions, which repeatedly derailed the business of the House," he said in his valedictory remarks before adjourning the House sine die.

On Thursday, the Upper House saw the approval of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to restrict states' powers to levy taxes on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands.

The Bill, which was passed by the Lok Sabha on Wednesday without a discussion, saw a brief discussion in the Upper House after it was taken up, dispensing with the Zero Hour and Question Hour.

Replying to the debate in the Upper House, Mines Minister G Kishan Reddy said the legislation does not seek to interfere with the autonomy or revenue rights of states, but aims to ensure uniform mineral rates across the country.

Defending the government's approach, Reddy said coal was crucial for power generation, with 73 per cent of India's electricity generation coming from coal. For Indian industry to remain competitive globally, availability of electricity is crucial, he said.

SAD chief Badal injured

The attacker has been taken into custody," Rohan told PTI.

According to police, Jaspal Singh had been working as a sewadar, or volunteer, at the gurdwara for about two years. He holds degrees in commerce and law and is

based in Pune, where his family lives, but had been staying alone in Nanded.

Police were investigating his background and trying to establish the motive. Rohan said Singh had initially claimed he was angry over the drugs problem in Punjab. "The exact reason for the attack will come out only after a detailed investigation," he said. Police had not found any gang connection or criminal background involving the accused so far.

A police officer, Santosh Kendre, who was part of Badal's special protection unit, was also injured while intervening to protect him. Badal was reportedly walking down a flight of stairs when the attack occurred.

Badal is protected under Z-plus security. However, his CISF cover is available only in Punjab and Delhi, with around 40 personnel deployed. Punjab Police personnel were accompanying him in Nanded when the attack took place.

The SAD described the incident as a serious security lapse. Senior party leader Bikram Singh Majithia, Badal's brother-in-law, called for a CBI inquiry or a probe monitored by a high court. He said the Badal family was visiting Maharashtra from August 12 to 14.

Majithia claimed the attacker first struck Badal's hand before trying to attack his chest with a knife. "Had the people standing nearby not shown courage, Punjab's political landscape could have been different today," he said. He also questioned who was behind repeated attempts to target Badal and said attacks on him threatened the voice of Hindu-Sikh unity and communal harmony in Punjab.

SAD spokesperson Arshdeep Singh Kler said Badal had suffered only a minor injury and was undergoing treatment. Party leader Virsa Singh Valtaha called for a thorough investigation into the incident and questioned whether other forces were involved.

Badal had visited Takht Sri Hazur Sahib, one of Sikhism's five Takhts, earlier in the day along with his wife and SAD MP Harsimrat Kaur Badal. Prime Minister Narendra Modi spoke to Harsimrat Kaur to enquire about Badal's health. Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis also spoke to Badal and sought details from the Nanded SP. Fadnavis directed the police to establish the motive behind the attack.

The incident drew condemnation from political and religious leaders across parties. Akal Takht Jathedar Giani Kuldip Singh Gargaji said an attack at a sacred place was deeply concerning and condemned the act. Punjab's ruling AAP general secretary Baltej Pannu said violence against Badal should not take place.

BJP leader R P Singh said political disagreements were part of democracy but violence could not be justified. Punjab BJP chief Kewal Singh Dhillion also condemned the attack. In Maharashtra, NCP (SP) MLA Rohit Pawar and Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Ambadas Danve called for a detailed investigation

and action against those responsible.

The attack comes less than two years after an attempt on Badal's life at the entrance of the Golden Temple in Amritsar in December 2024. At that time, Badal was performing sewadar duty after the Akal Takht had imposed religious punishment, or tankhah, over "mistakes" during the SAD-led Punjab government from 2007 to 2017.

The accused in that case, Narain Singh Chaura, was overpowered by people nearby and handed over to police. Chaura had approached Badal, who was then sitting in a wheelchair because of a fractured leg, and pulled a gun from his pocket before being stopped.

SC to decide

paper of distorting proceedings and making remarks that breached its privileges.

On November 7, 2003, Speaker K Kalimuthu passed a resolution holding that the publication constituted a breach of privilege. The Assembly subsequently ordered the arrest of members of the newspaper's editorial staff. Police arrested Editor N Ravi, Executive Editor Malini Parthasarathy, Bureau Chief V Jayant, Special Correspondent Radha Venkatesan and Publisher S Rangarajan.

A Supreme Court bench of Justices Y K Sabharwal and S B Sinha stayed the arrests on November 10, saying the House appeared to have misread the law.

The dispute also brought conflicting earlier rulings on Articles 19(1)(a), 21 and 194 into focus. In December 2003, a two-judge bench referred the matter to a five-judge Constitution Bench, which later sent it to a seven-judge bench.

The matter was listed before then CJI D Y Chandrachud in October 2023. On October 12, a seven-judge bench, including the present CJI Surya Kant, agreed to hear it and had initially proposed March 2024. The hearing will now begin on October 6.

NALSAR

participation in NALSAR's convocation.

The university's convocation date has not yet been announced. A section of NALSAR students had written to the Vice-Chancellor, Registrar and professors opposing any proposal to invite the CJI as the chief guest.

In its first communication, the BCI said it was examining the allegations and had sought a report identifying those responsible. It said a final decision would be taken on August 19 after examining the material placed before it.

The decision was later modified after the backlash. In the revised communication, Mishra said the BCI's members had discussed the earlier order and unanimously agreed to change the direction concerning the students' enrolment.

"All the students will be entitled to get enrolled with the State Bar Councils of their choice," Mishra said.

The council said a report it had subsequently received indicated that the "vast majority" of the 2026 gradu-

ates were innocent and had not intended to participate in the alleged act of disrespect. It also said information from "reliable sources" suggested that a handful of teachers and outsiders had allegedly played a role in instigating innocent students.

The BCI said it would wait for the inquiry report from the NALSAR Vice-Chancellor before considering any further action. It directed the Vice-Chancellor to conduct an inquiry into the matter.

The revised order specifically modified the chairman's earlier letter and allowed the graduates to proceed with enrolment despite the ongoing inquiry.

"No student shall be made to suffer without any fault on his part," the council said.

The earlier decision was criticised by Supreme Court Bar Association (SCBA) president Vikas Singh, who described it as "illegal, disproportionate and fundamentally unsustainable". He said the move amounted to an attempt to intimidate law students for exercising their right to freedom of speech and expression.

"Universities are meant to be campuses of free thought and fearless debate," Singh said.

With the revised order, the 2026 NALSAR graduates can now seek enrolment with state bar councils while the university-level inquiry continues. Further action by the BCI will depend on the report submitted by the Vice-Chancellor.

No tip

August 11, 2026, requires aggregators to review their apps and digital platforms with immediate effect and comply with the Motor Vehicle Aggregator Guidelines, 2025.

The ministry cited prompts such as "Advance Tip", "Choose an Add-on", and "Improve your chances of quicker ride confirmation", as well as messages suggesting that a driver may be more likely to accept a trip if a tip is added. It said any interface that "directly or indirectly encourages, induces, or creates an impression" that an extra payment could improve the ride experience must be removed or modified without delay.

Under Clause 14.15 of the 2025 guidelines, passengers may voluntarily tip drivers, but the option can appear only after the journey ends. The full tip must be credited to the driver, with no deduction by the aggregator.

The clause also bars tipping mechanisms that are misleading or manipulative or violate the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. The latest directive follows earlier concerns over pre-ride tipping practices and reinforces that tipping must remain voluntary and post-ride.

The clause also bars tipping mechanisms that are misleading or manipulative or violate the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. The latest directive follows earlier concerns over pre-ride tipping practices and reinforces that tipping must remain voluntary and post-ride.

'Last chance'

government could either implement the proposed labels or face judicial intervention. The court also asked whether the government was unwilling to comply with its earlier directions and whether it was under pressure from corporate interests.

The hearing took place during proceedings on a public interest litigation seeking mandatory warnings to help consumers identify products containing high levels of sugar, salt and saturated fat before purchase. The petitioner's counsel referred to the minutes of an FSSAI meeting held on March 7, saying its position appeared contrary to the court's earlier directions. The bench also referred to its February 10, 2026, order on the issue.

FSSAI has cited opposition from the food industry and proposed a tabular declaration of recommended daily requirements for added sugar, saturated fats and salt instead of the proposed warning system. The petitioner's side told the court that the FSSAI affidavit had not adequately considered evidence submitted by civil society groups supporting warning labels.

Additional Solicitor General Brijender Chahar, appearing for the Centre, said applying strict international standards could create difficulties for traditional Indian foods. He cited products such as namkeen that could receive red warning symbols and argued that dietary patterns in India differed from those in developed countries. He also said that even two eggs could exceed prescribed daily fat limits.

The bench rejected the argument that India could not follow standards used internationally. "Should India remain an undeveloped country?" it asked, adding that the country should be seen as concerned about the health of its citizens, especially children.

The judges said the labels were meant to inform consumers rather than stop sales. "Manufacturers might not like it, but the consumer ought to know," the bench said. It also rejected the suggestion that manufacturers should have a decisive role in policy.

Senior advocate Maninder Singh, appearing for a manufacturer, sought to make submissions, while senior advocate Devadutt Kamat suggested categorising products and displaying detailed nutritional information. The bench said it was not against any particular product and referred to affordability and children's consumption habits while stressing the need for clear information.

The issue has also been examined by Parliament's Committee on Subordinate Legislation, headed by Shiv Sena Rajya Sabha MP Milind Deora, which has advocated studying Singapore's Nutri-Grade model. Separately, the Union health ministry has proposed "sugar and oil boards" in schools, offices and other public institutions to promote healthier eating habits.

Air India

flying from Phuket to Delhi, which lost about 300 feet (91 metres) during turbulence. The aircraft had 145 people on board, including 137 passengers and eight crew members, with at least 24 people injured. Sources said the pilot-in-command initially tested positive for a psychoactive substance, while a confirmatory test identified marijuana. The pilot's name has not been disclosed.

The Tata Group-owned airlines have more than 5,000 pilots. According to an internal communication, testing will cover substances and medications prohibited under aviation rules. Checks will be conducted at Air India's Gurugram academy, briefing centres, airline offices and locations linked to pilots' home bases.

The incident remains under investigation amid scrutiny of pilot fitness and compliance with safety regulations. MPOST

NHAI sets

Ambulances must also take accident victims to the nearest hospital within one hour of accepting a service ticket. Rejection of an emergency ticket will also attract a Rs 10,000 penalty. For incidents beyond 10 km, the response time will increase proportionately and be verified through GPS and the IMS Care Dashboard.

Around 3,000 ambulances and 1,000 patrolling vehicles and cranes cover nearly 50,000 km of NHAI highways. All on-road units have AIS-140 compliant GPS devices and dedicated mobile data terminals with IoT SIMs. The 1033 helpline operates across the national highway network. NHAI said strict compliance was required as delays affect public health and safety. MPOST

TMC

The petition is expected to be filed within the next seven to 10 days, as the TMC steps up pressure on Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla over the defection complaints pending before his office.

TMC general secretary and Lok Sabha leader Abhishek Banerjee met Birla on Wednesday and pressed for a decision on the petitions, which were filed against each of the 20 MPs in June. Banerjee indicated that the party would seek the Supreme Court's intervention if the Speaker did not act within the timeframe prescribed by law and judicial directions.

The issue has become a point of friction between the TMC and the Speaker's office, with the party arguing that prolonged inaction could undermine the anti-defection provisions. Banerjee said he had submitted a letter seeking action on July 26, but had received no satisfactory response.

The 20 MPs, among them rebel leader Kakoli Ghosh Dasgupta, have announced their merger with NCPI, an obscure party based in Howrah. They claim that their group constitutes more than two-thirds of the TMC's 28-member Lok Sabha strength, and have sought separate seats in the House.

The rebels have participated in meetings of the National Democratic Alliance, even as Lok Sabha records continue to identify them as TMC members.

The TMC disputes the rebels' claim that their move is protected by the merger exception under the anti-defection law. It maintains that by joining another political formation, the MPs have voluntarily given up their membership of the party, making them liable for disqualification.

OPPOSITION SAYS PROTESTS SET THE POLITICAL AGENDA

Beyond the Well: Oppn claims ‘protest-powered’ Monsoon win

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE
New Delhi, August 13

With the conclusion of the latest Monsoon Session of the Parliament on Thursday, the Opposition camp stated that the whole show belonged to them.

There were intense political confrontations in the session, which started on July 20, between the government and the Opposition, with all sorts of disruptions, protests, and exchanges filling the session.

In its evaluation, the Opposition also stated that the political discourse was entirely dominated by its protests and that the government had no response to the issues raised in and out of the House. Moreover, there was a unique kind of political protest seen, wherein the Opposition members resorted to different ways and means to attract public attention towards their demands.

Sometimes, the protests went beyond the stage of criticising the government to even ridiculing it and indulging in political satire as a result of the confrontation between the treasury benches and the Opposition.

At the same time, the Opposition parties continuously demanded discussions on various topics in the Monsoon Session since



A donation box placed by Opposition leaders against the alleged Ram Temple theft PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The session, which began on July 20, was marked by repeated confrontations between the government and the Opposition, with disruptions, protests and heated exchanges becoming a regular feature
- » At times, the protests went beyond conventional criticism and turned into political theatre, ridiculing the government and highlighting issues through visual and symbolic messaging

its start, while the government insisted on taking care of legislative business and other matters.

Against this background, the Opposition tried to paint the session as an instance wherein parliamentary protests could

become a potent political tool. In other words, apart from the political challenge posed by the protests, they showed a new way of communication that was more effective than Parliament alone. What is interesting is that the Opposition’s

use of symbolism became more prominent in this session. They resorted to placards, slogans, and other innovative ways to show their dissent, making many instances in Parliament political issues to be discussed in public forums. It further complained about the manner in which the government dealt with notices by MPs regarding discussions on different issues. It was said that while many notices were not given the attention they deserved, important Bills were passed through disruptions and lack of debate.

A second issue raised during the political assess-

ment of the session related to the attendance of high-level representatives from the government.

The Opposition brought out the fact that, apart from the presence of the Prime Minister Narendra Modi in the Parliament on the occasion when national song ‘Vande Mataram’ was sung on the Floor of the House for the first time in independent India, neither the Prime Minister nor the Home Minister Amit Shah was present in Parliament during the session in the way the Opposition had expected them to be. This was said to be an unprecedented situation and was linked to the political climate prevailing in connection with the session.

The Opposition also brought up the question of how legislative work was being conducted, accusing the government of introducing and passing several bills without proper discussion.

The Opposition said parliamentary democracy requires proper scrutiny of legislation through debate and committees, while the government pressed ahead with its legislative agenda. The session thus ended with rival narratives—government touting its legislative gains and the Opposition claiming it kept its issues in the spotlight.

INDIA bloc skips Birla’s tea party; Kharage, Sonia join RS event

Congress, Trinamool, SP stay away

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 13

The Congress, Trinamool Congress (TMC) and Samajwadi Party (SP) on Thursday boycotted the customary tea party hosted by Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla after the House was adjourned sine die, even as some opposition leaders attended a similar gathering hosted by Rajya Sabha Chairman CP Radhakrishnan. Sources said Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) leader Kanimozhi was among those who attended the traditional get-together hosted by Birla.

In the Rajya Sabha, Congress president and Leader of the Opposition in the Upper House Mallikarjun Kharge, former Congress president Sonia Gandhi and other opposition leaders attended the tea party hosted by Radhakrishnan.

‘One leader’s ego’ derailed Monsoon Session: BJP

New Delhi: The BJP on Thursday accused Congress leader Rahul Gandhi of repeatedly changing goalposts on discussions in Parliament and alleged that the Monsoon Session had fallen victim to “one leader’s ego, indiscipline and insolence”. The party also alleged that hundreds of crores of rupees of taxpayers’ money were wasted due to Gandhi’s “arrogance and obstinacy”. Senior BJP leader and MP Ravi Shankar Prasad said that the Opposition did not allow Parliament to function despite the government’s readiness for discussions. Calling Gandhi irresponsible and “immature”, Prasad accused him of lacking political propriety.

AGENCIES

The gatherings are a customary feature following the conclusion of proceedings in both Houses and are held in the respective chambers of the Speaker and Chairman.

According to sources, PM Narendra Modi, Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and several senior

leaders and Union ministers were present at the tea party in Birla’s chamber. A senior Congress leader confirmed that leaders of the Congress, TMC, SP and several other INDIA bloc parties did not participate in the Lok Sabha Speaker’s event.

SC to hear plea challenging facial recognition at Jantar Mantar protests

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 13

The Supreme Court on Thursday agreed to hear a plea filed by a Rajya Sabha lawmaker challenging the alleged deployment of facial recognition technology and other biometric surveillance measures by Delhi Police during the recent student protest at Jantar Mantar here.

A bench of Chief Justice

THE BENCH DIRECTED THE MATTER BE TAGGED WITH EARLIER PETITIONS

Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana directed the matter be tagged with earlier petitions on the issue.

Senior advocate Menaka Guruswamy, appearing for Rajya Sabha

MP AA Rahim, said there are two issues which are a matter of concern—facial recognition of protestors done by Delhi police and data stored by private companies. “One maps your face and one is a vehicle. So spectacles are used and a vehicle is also used. And that data is all taken without permission. These private entities host the data. In violation of the rules...,” she submitted.

INDEPENDENCE DAY CELEBRATIONS- 2026

DELHI POLICE SHANTI SEWA NYAYA

TRAFFIC ADVISORY

15th AUGUST, 2026 (4:00 A.M. TO 10:00 A.M.)

Independence Day Ceremony will be celebrated on 15th August 2026 at Red Fort. Hon'ble Prime Minister of India will address the nation from the rampart of Red Fort. As such for the convenience of public and security reasons, certain traffic restrictions have been imposed around the Red Fort on 15th August 2026.

TRAFFIC RESTRICTIONS AROUND RED FORT

The following roads will be closed for general traffic from 04.00 AM to 10.00 AM on 15.08.2026 and only labeled vehicles will be permitted:

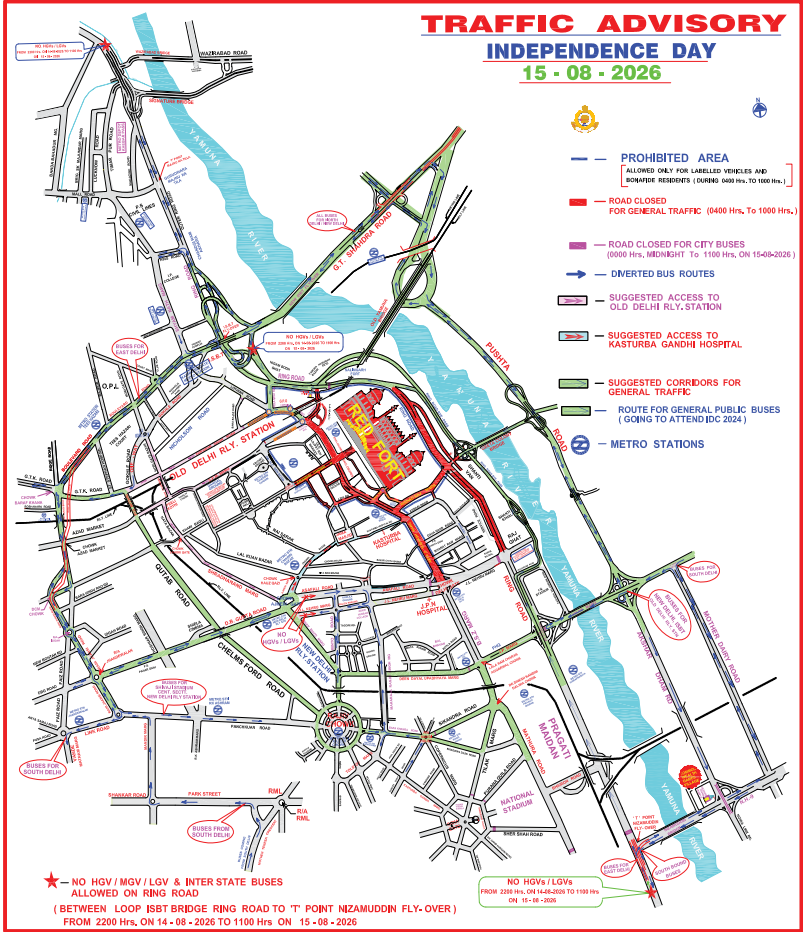
1. Netaji Subhash Marg from Delhi Gate to Chhatta Rail Chowk.
2. Lohian Road from GPO Delhi to Chhatta Rail Chowk.
3. S.P. Mukherjee Marg from H.C. Sen Marg to Yamuna Bazar Chowk.
4. Chandni Chowk Road from Fountain Chowk to Red Fort.
5. Nishad Raj Marg from Ring Road to Netaji Subhash Marg.
6. Esplanade Road and its Link Road to Netaji Subhash Marg.
7. Ring Road from Rajghat to ISBT.

ROADS THAT MAY BE AVOIDED FROM 04.00 AM TO 10.00 AM on 15.08.2026

Those vehicles which do not have parking labels for the rehearsal may avoid C- Hexagon India Gate, Copernicus Marg, Mandi House, Sikandra Road, W-Point, A-Point, Tilak Marg, Mathura Road, BSZ Marg, Netaji Subhash Marg, J.L. Nehru Marg, Ring Road between Nizamuddin Khatta and ISBT Kashmiri Gate & Outer Ring Road from Nizamuddin Khatta & ISBT Kashmiri Gate via Salimgarh bypass.

NORTH-SOUTH ACCESS

- Alternative-1: Aurbindo Marg – Safdarjung Road – Kamal Ataturk Marg- Kautilya Marg- S Marg- 11 Murti- Mother Teresa Crescent- Park Street- Mandir Marg – Panchkuan Road – Rani Jhansi Road and reach their destinations in North Delhi and vice-versa.
- Alternative-2: Reach Connaught Place – Minto Road – Bhavbhuti Marg – Ajmeri Gate –Shradhanand Marg – Lahori Gate Chowk – Naya Bazar – Peeli Kothi – S.P. Mukherjee Marg up to ODRS and reach their destination in North Delhi and vice versa.
- Alternative-3: Reach Nizamuddin Bridge to cross Yamuna – Pushta Road – G.T. Road and cross Yudhisthira Setu to ISBT and reach their destination in North Delhi and vice versa.



EAST WEST ACCESS

1. NH-24 (NH-9) - Nizamuddin Khatta - Barapulla Road- under AIIMS Flyover- Ring Road.
 2. DND- Barapulla Road further as per 1 above OR via Ashram on Ring Road & proceed accordingly.
 3. NH-24 (NH-9)- Nizamuddin Khatta- Ring Road- Bhairon Road- Mathura Road-Subrahmanyam Bharti Marg- Rajesh Pilot Marg- Pithivir Road- Safdarjung Road- Kamal Ataturk Marg- Panchsheel Marg- SP Marg/Ridge Road accordingly and vice versa.
 4. Vikas Marg- IP Marg- DDU Marg- Minto Road then either via Connaught Place or Ajmeri Gate - DBG & proceed further.
 5. Pusta Road (Shastri Park)- GT Road- Yudhister Setu- ISBT Kashmini Gate and proceed accordingly via Ring Road or Rani Jhansi Road.
- DND – NH24 (NH9) – Yudhister Setu- Signature Bridge- Wazirabad Bridge will remain open to reach Ring Road.
- Old Iron Bridge and Geeta Colony Bridge towards Shanti Van will be closed. People are advised to reach early to avoid last minute rush & inconvenience.

SIGNAGES

Adequate informative signages will be displayed for the guidance of vehicular traffic destined for the Red Fort at all important traffic junctions.

RESTRICTIONS ON MOVEMENT OF COMMERCIAL TRANSPORT AND INTERSTATE BUSES

1. Goods vehicles will not be permitted between Nizamuddin Khatta and Wazirabad Bridge from 12:00 Midnight of 14.08.2026 to 11:00 AM on 15.08.2026.
2. Interstate buses will not be allowed between Maharana Pratap ISBT and Sarai Kale Khan ISBT from 12:00 Midnight of 14.08.2026 to 11:00 AM on 15.08.2026.

RESTRICTIONS ON MOVEMENT OF CITY BUSES APART FROM RESTRICTED ROADS

- Local city buses including DTC will not move on Ring Road from 12:00 midnight of 14.08.2026 to 11:00 AM on 15.08.2026 between ISBT Kashmini Gate and Ring Road - NH-24 (NH-9) / NH-TT point (Nizamuddin Khatta) and take available alternative route. The following road shall also be closed for movement for Inter City/DTC buses from 12:00 midnight on 14.08.2026 to 11:00 AM on 15.08.2026:
- A. Lohian Road from Chhatta Rail Chowk to Kashmini Gate (Boulevard Road).
 - B. Netaji Subhash Marg from Chhatta Rail Chowk to Delhi Gate.
 - C. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee Marg.
 - D. Ring Road between Nizamuddin Khatta (NH-24) and Northern loop of ISBT Kashmini Gate.
 - E. 'C' Hexagon, Sher Shah Road, Dr Jakir Hussain Road, Pandara Road, Shahjahan Road, Akbar Road, Rajpath, Ashoka Road, KG Marg, Copernicus Marg, Tilak Marg, Purana Quila Road, Sikandara Road, Bhagwan Dass Road and BSZ Marg.
 - F. Ashoka Road- Ridge Road (Vande Matram Place to 'C' Hexagon).
 - G. KG. Marg from Ferozeshah Road to 'C' Hexagon.
 - H. Vikas Marg, beyond loop towards Delhi Secretariat.
 - I. Mathura Road from Ashram Chowk to W Point.

Buses ordinarily terminating at Red Fort, Jama Masjid and Delhi Main Railway Station will be curtailed/diverted as below:

- 1) Opposite Ramilla Ground on J.L.N. Marg for buses approaching from South Delhi and West Delhi.
- 2) At Mori Gate and Tis Hazari - for buses coming from North, North West via Baraf Khana and East Delhi via ISBT Bridge.
- 3) At Boulevard Road opp. Maharaja Agrasen Park, for buses coming from North Delhi side from Ring Road.

Normal bus services will be restored after 11:00 AM.

HOW TO APPROACH/REACH IMPORTANT PLACES

- (1) OLD DELHI RAILWAY STATION
- a. From West and South Delhi: Mother Teresa Crescent - Park Street - Mandir Marg - Panchkuan Road - Rani Jhansi Flyover - Azad Market - Boulevard Road - Mori Gate - Pul Dufferin - S.P. Mukherjee Marg to reach the Railway Station or Dhaula Kuan- Ridge Road (Vande Matram Place to 'C' Hexagon - Rani Jhansi Road & thereafter as above & vice versa.
 - b. From North: Mori Gate - Pul Dufferin - S.P. Mukherjee Marg to reach the Railway Station.
 - c. From East/North East: Pusta Road- Yudhister Setu - Mori Gate - Pul Dufferin- SP Mukherjee Marg then proceed further accordingly.
- (2) NEW DELHI RLY. STATION
- a. From East: Vikas Marg, DDU Marg, Bhavbhuti Marg, New Delhi Railway Station.
 - b. From North East: Yudhister Setu, Rani Jhansi Road, R/A Rani Jhansi, DBG Road and reach New Delhi Railway Station accordingly OR via Mori Gate, Pul Dufferin, SP Mukherjee Marg, Outub Road and reach their destination.

- c. From North: Rani Jhansi Road, R/A Jhandewalan, DBG Road and reach New Delhi Railway Station accordingly OR via Mori Gate, Pul Dufferin, SP Mukherjee Marg, Outub Road and reach their destination.
- d. From West: Pusa Road, R/A Hanuman Murti, Panchkua Road, Connaught Place, Chelmsford Road and New Delhi Railway Station OR via DBG Road to reach New Delhi Railway Station.
- e. From South: To reach Connaught Place, Chelmsford Road and New Delhi Railway Station OR via DBG Road to reach New Delhi Railway Station.

(3) ISBT KASHMERE GATE

- a. From New Delhi and South Delhi: Mother Teresa Crescent - Park Street - Mandir Marg - Panchkuan Road - Rani Jhansi Road and Rani Jhansi Flyover - Boulevard Road.
- b. From West Delhi: Pusa Road, R/A Hanuman Mandir, Faiz Road, Rani Jhansi Road and thereafter as above.
- c. From North Delhi: There is no restriction.
- d. From North-East Delhi: Yudhister Setu, Boulevard Road, Mori Gate, Pul Dufferin, SP Mukherjee Marg, Old Delhi Railway Station.
- 4) LNJP Hospital: There is no restriction.
- 5) Kasturba Hospital: Ajmeri Gate - Ajmeri Bazar - Chowk Hauz Quazi - Chawri Bazar - Chowk- Barsha Bullah- Urdu Bazar.

DIVERSIONS

FROM TRANS YAMUNA AREA

- (i) G.T ROAD/ISBT KASHMERE GATE BRIDGE:
1. Buses bound for Kauria Pul/Red Fort/Old Delhi Railway Station shall operate via ISBT Bridge (Yudhister Setu) and terminate at Boulevard Road-Near Mori Gate U Turn. Return route via Boulevard Road after taking 'U' turn from Mori Gate 'U' - turn for ISBT Bridge (Yudhister Setu).
 2. Buses bound for New Delhi/Connaught Place/Central Secretariat shall operate via new ISBT Bridge - Boulevard Road Rani Jhansi Flyover- Rani Jhansi Road - Mandir Marg - Peshwa Road - Gole Market & Shivaji Stadium Terminal / Central Secretariat Terminal.
 3. Buses bound for South Delhi shall follow the route above up to Mandir Marg and proceed further via Shankar Road - Upper Ridge Road, Simon Bolivar Marg- Dhaula Kuan.
- (ii) VIKAS MARG
1. Buses bound for North Delhi shall proceed via Marginal Bandh Road (Pusta), G.T Road, Shastri Park, ISBT Bridge, Boulevard Road and proceed further.
 2. Buses bound for South Delhi shall proceed via Mother Diary Road, NH - 24, towards Nizamuddin Bridge - Ring Road towards Ashram Chowk.
 3. Buses bound for New Delhi shall board the passengers on Vikas Marg, New Secretariat. Bus stand and will take U turn from under IP Flyover for return journey towards Vikas Marg.

BUSES COMING FROM BARAF KHANA

- All Buses otherwise terminating at Old Delhi Railway Station/Kauria Pul/Red Fort/ Jama Masjid shall be curtailed as mentioned below:-
1. Buses coming from Roshanara Road for Old Delhi Railway Station shall terminate opposite State Bank of India inside Tis Hazari Court. Return journey will be via Gokhale Road - Zorawar Singh Marg.
 2. Buses coming from New Gokhale Road for Old Delhi Railway Station, Red Fort shall terminate on Gokhale Marg between Tikona Park and In Gate Tis Hazari Court. Return journey will be via Gokhale Road - Zorawar Singh Marg.
 4. Buses coming from Malka Gani for Old Delhi Railway Station, Red Fort shall terminate on Gokhale Marg adjoining boundary wall of Tikona Park. Return journey will be via Gokhale Road - Zorawar Singh Marg.
 5. All private and mini buses shall be terminated at MCD car parking (MORI GATE). Gokhale road shall be one- way from R/A Mori Gate towards PS Metro Station Kashmini Gate & R/A Mori Gate to Gokhale Market 'T' Point.

BUSES COMING FROM AJMERI GATE/ MINTO BRIDGE

All Buses otherwise terminating at Old Delhi Railway Station, Red Fort, Bhai Mati Dass Chowk, Mori Gate, ISBT, Pragati Maidan and Ambedkar Stadium Terminal shall terminate opposite Turkman Gate, Asaf Ali Road. Return journey by taking 'U' Turn on JLN Marg and proceed further.

BUSES COMING FROM MALL ROAD SIDE

All buses otherwise terminating at Old Delhi Railway Station, Red Fort, Jama Masjid, Kauria Pul shall terminate on Boulevard Road up to Mori Gate. Return journey will be via Boulevard Road, Ring Road and Chandni Bazar Akhara, IP College light point.

BUSES COMING FROM SOUTH DELHI

Buses bound for Red Fort, Old Delhi Railway Station, Bhai Mati Dass Chowk (Fountain) from South Delhi will be diverted via Ring Road - NH -24, Marginal Bandh (Pushta) Road, new ISBT Bridge and shall terminate on Boulevard Road. Return journey by taking 'U' Turn and proceed further via ISBT Bridge.

1. Buses bound for Connaught Place from South Delhi shall be diverted towards Ring Road and further take Upper Ridge Road up to R/A Kauri Bagh and reach Connaught Place via Jhandewalan, Panchkuan Road/ Shivaji Stadium terminal.
2. Buses bound for ISBT Maharana Pratap Terminal shall proceed on Ring Road and further take Upper Ridge Road up to R/A Karol Bagh - Faiz Road - Filmistan - Azad Mkt. Chowk - Boulevard Road and reach Mori Gate ISBT.
3. Buses bound for East Delhi from South Delhi shall proceed via Ring Road - Hazrat Nizamuddin Bridge- (NH - 24) - New Patlipat Gani Road.
4. Buses bound for East Delhi from South Delhi coming at Lala Lajpat Rai Marg will be diverted on Mathura Road towards the Ashram Chowk - Ring Road from Lodhi Fly over R/A Neela Gumbad.
5. Buses bound for Red Fort, Jama Masjid, Kauria Pul from Firoz Shah Road and going towards Mandi House shall take Barakhamba Road from Mandi House, Ranjit Singh Flyover and terminate Opp. Turkman Gate Ashram Chowk.
6. Mudrika Services (Buses) shall take route via new ISBT Bridge - Shastri Park - Pusta Kailash - Gandhi Nagar - Vikas Marg - Mother Dairy Road- NH-24 - Nizamuddin Bridge - turn left Ring Road for Sarai Kale Khan.

INTER STATE BUSES

INCOMING:

1. All buses coming from Ghaziabad towards Delhi shall move via Bhopura Chungi Road from Mohan Nagar for Wazirabad and then towards Chandni Ram Akhara – U-Turn ISBT and enter ISBT Kashmere Gate.
2. All Buses coming from Dhaula Kuan shall be diverted on Ring Road for taking Punjabi Bagh - Azadpur - Akhara Chandni Ram - U turn ISBT and enter ISBT Kashmere Gate.
3. All Buses coming from Faridabad (Badarpur) shall either terminate at Sarai Kale Khan or be diverted on Ring Road via Dhaula Kuan Punjabi Bagh - Azadpur - Chandni Ram Akhara - U turn ISBT and enter ISBT Kashmere Gate.

OUTGOING:

1. No bus shall be allowed to take 'U' turn at northern loop of Ring Road near Budh Vihar (Monastery) and would be diverted towards Wazirabad to go Trans Yamuna or take U turn from Chandni Ram Akhara and take loop of ISBT Flyover to go towards Shastri Park and Buses bound for Dhaula Kuan shall take Boulevard Road, Rani Jhansi Road, Link Road and upper Ridge Road (Vande Matram Marg).
2. Buses bound for Loni Border shall proceed via Wazirabad Bridge and those bound for Ghaziabad shall proceed via ISBT Bridge.

DTC RECOVERY VANS

DTC recovery vans shall be stationed (from 05.00 Hrs on 15.08.2026 onward till diversions are cleared) as below:-

1. Central Control Room - Gokhale Marg, 2. Ghata Masjid 3. Yamuna Bazar 4. Delhi Gate 5. Chhatta Rail Chowk.

Note: BUSES ORIGINATING FROM EAST, NORTH, CENTRAL, WEST, SOUTH AND INTENDING TO USE TILAK MARG - BSZ MARG - SUBASH MARG - RING ROAD BETWEEN AKHARA CHANDNI RAM AND HAZRAT NIZAMUDDIN BRIDGE BE DIVERTED TO AVOID THESE STRETCHES & TAKE ALTERNATIVE ROUTES AS SUGGESTED ABOVE.

SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS

1. General public is advised not to bring cameras, binoculars, Remote Control car keys, umbrellas, handbags, briefcases, transistors, cigarette lighters, tiffin boxes, water bottles, lunch boxes etc.
2. Members of the public are requested not to touch any suspicious object. They are requested to immediately report about the presence of any unidentified/suspected object, suspicious movement of individuals & vehicles or anything out of the ordinary, to the nearest policeman.
3. Flying of sub conventional aerial platforms like Para-gliders, para-motors, hang gliders, UAVs, micro light aircraft, remotely piloted aircraft, hot air balloons, small-size powered aircraft, quadcopters or para jumping from territory etc. are prohibited over the jurisdiction of National Capital Territory of Delhi vide PHQ order dated from 02.08.2026 to 16.08.2026 (both days inclusive).

300 UNNAMED BOOKED FOR AUG 10 VIOLENCE

Jharkhand protesters to take out Tiranga Yatra on August 15

MPOST BUREAU

Ranchi, August 13

The students' protest against alleged irregularities in Jharkhand recruitment examinations entered 20th day on Thursday, with the agitators announcing a 'Tiranga Yatra' on August 15, while an FIR was lodged against 300 unnamed people over the August 10 march towards the Assembly, during which protesters clashed with security personnel.

The state CID also conducted raids at multiple locations to execute arrest warrants against seven accused in cases related to alleged irregularities in competitive examinations conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC), officials said.

The protest, under the banner of JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium here continued with students demanding greater transparency in recruitment exams, cancellation of several tests and an independent probe by the CBI or a panel of retired judges from outside Jharkhand.

The students said they would take out a 'Tiranga Yatra' on August 15 to strengthen their agitation and warned the state government against lodging cases against genuine protesters.

Police registered an FIR



Student and aspirant Rupesh Kumar Pandey stages a hunger strike during a protest with others at Jaipal Singh Munda Stadium, in Ranchi

PTI

THE ROW

- » The students said they would take out a 'Tiranga Yatra' to strengthen their agitation
- » They also warned the state government against lodging cases against genuine protesters

against 300 unnamed people in connection with the August 10 march towards the Jharkhand Assembly, which led to clashes between protesters and security personnel.

The case, registered at Vidhan Sabha police station, relates to alleged violation of prohibitory orders, damage to government property and attacks on police personnel, Ranchi SP Paras Rana said.

DSP (Hatia) Neeraj Kumar said no arrests or detentions had been made in the August 10 case and

that police were examining video footage to identify those involved.

Fourteen police personnel were injured during the confrontation, following which police used batons, water cannons and tear gas to disperse protesters.

The Ranchi administration had imposed prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS within a 750-metre radius of the Assembly ahead of the Monsoon session.

Reacting to the FIR, JPSC-JSSC Reforms Manch leader Ravindra Paswan

appealed to the government not to target genuine students.

"If the administration has registered an FIR against unidentified persons, we do not have any objection. But, we would like to appeal to the administration and the Jharkhand government not to file an FIR against any student," Paswan said.

The students forum also accused the Congress, a constituent of the ruling JMM-led coalition, of spreading misinformation about the student delegation that met a government panel.

The protesters brandished their identity cards after Congress minister Shilpy Neha Turkey alleged that the delegation did not adequately represent students.

SC: Justice must prevail over superstition, irrational beliefs

'Witch-hunting threat to constitutional democracy'

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 13

A constitutional democracy cannot survive if derogatory practices such as witch-hunting continue to elude the principles of rule of law and constitutional morality, the Supreme Court said on Thursday.

The apex court upheld the conviction and life sentence awarded to a man who, along with a co-accused, had dragged a woman from her house and assaulted her in 1998 while branding her as a practitioner of witchcraft in Odisha. The woman died due to the assault.

"While parting with the case, we would just like to say that the facts of the present case have deeply disturbed the conscience of this court, wherein a defenseless woman was branded as a practitioner of witchcraft and what effect it must have had on the daughter of the



deceased who had to witness her mother being killed in the most brutal way," a bench of Justices Prashant Kumar Mishra and N V Anjaria said.

It said the Constitution of India envisioned a society founded on the principles of equality, fraternity, scientific temperament, wherein any practice derogatory to women was to be discarded.

The bench said despite this, practices such as witch-hunting continue to persist within few sections of the society. "A constitutional democracy such as ours cannot survive; wherein such derogatory practices continue to elude the principles of rule of law

and constitutional morality," it said. "This court fervently hopes that the present case serves as a solemn reminder that justice must always prevail over superstition and irrational beliefs," it said.

The top court delivered its verdict on an appeal filed by one Balku Oram who had challenged a September 2022 order of the Orissa High Court.

The high court had affirmed the conviction and life sentence imposed on the appellant by a trial court. In its verdict, the apex court quoted Dr B R Ambedkar: "A just society is that society in which ascending sense of reverence and descending sense of contempt is dissolved into the creation of a compassionate society."

The bench said it is true that the malady of witch-hunting still plagues sections of the society where prejudice, superstition and irrational fear supersedes the rule of law.

HP CM picks Barsar for state-level I-Day function

ASHWANI SHARMA

Shimla, August 13

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu will hoist the national flag at Barsar in Hamirpur district on August 15, holding the state-level Independence Day function there in a move seen as an effort to increase his penetration in smaller towns ahead of next year's Assembly elections.

Barsar has political significance for Sukhu, who hails from Hamirpur district. The constituency was represented by Congress MLA Inder Dutt Lakhanpal, who was among six party MLAs

who rebelled against the chief minister during the Rajya Sabha polls in February 2024.

The six legislators were disqualified from the

Assembly. Lakhanpal later joined the BJP and was among two rebels who won re-election.

Sukhu has earlier held state-level functions at Dehra and Pangi. The chief minister's Independence Day address from Barsar will also be live-streamed in schools across the state, a government spokesperson said.

Meanwhile, the state

Bihar's Bhojpur encounter: CM announces aid for victim's family

MPOST BUREAU

Patna, August 13

Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary on Thursday announced a government job for one family member of Bharat Tiwary, who was allegedly killed in a police encounter in Bhojpur district on June 17.

Choudhary said the government would also provide financial assistance to Tiwary's family based on the interim report of a judicial inquiry into the incident.

Tiwary's death triggered a row, with his family alleging that he had surrendered and discarded his weapon before police opened fire. They also cited purported social media videos showing him unarmed. Police, however, claimed Tiwary opened fire with an illegal firearm when officers attempted to arrest him, forcing them to retaliate in self-defence. He was injured and later died during treatment.

Briefs

Sonipat gets skill centre

SONIPAT: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday inaugurated the Regional Skill Development Centre at Deenbandhu Chhotu Ram University of Science and Technology, Murthal, here.

Saini said that the skills of the youth are shaping the direction of Viksit Bharat and Viksit Haryana.

MoCA holds Tiranga Rally

NEW DELHI: The Civil Aviation ministry (MoCA) on Thursday organised a Tiranga Rally under the Har Ghar Tiranga campaign, with Union Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Rammohan Naidu flagging off the procession here at Udaan Bhawan. Senior officials, including Civil Aviation Secretary Samir Kumar Sinha, and employees of the ministry, its attached offices, PSUs and autonomous bodies participated in it.

Manipur: 2 minors held

CHURACHANDPUR: Two minors, allegedly members of a proscribed outfit, were apprehended with arms and ammunition in Manipur's Churachandpur district.

An AK-series rifle with a magazine and 12 rounds of ammunition, a 9 mm pistol with a magazine, and a radio set were recovered from their possession.

New railway line through Siliguri Corridor gets nod

MPOST BUREAU

Katihar, August 13

A fourth railway line through the strategically important 'Chicken's Neck', also known as the Siliguri Corridor, has been approved by the Centre, a senior official said.

Northeast Frontier Railway General Manager Chetan Kumar Shrivastava said the Malda-New Jalpaiguri section is a crucial rail corridor connecting the Northeast with other parts of the country.

"A third line had earlier been proposed for the section, but approval has now been accorded for a fourth line as well. In addition, the nearly 29-km double-line underground project between Tinmai Ghat and Bagdogra is another important infrastructure initiative," he said, addressing a press conference on Wednesday night.

Given the strategic importance of the region,

THIS WILL BE THE FOURTH RAIL LINE THROUGH THE STRATEGICALLY IMPORTANT 'CHICKEN'S NECK'

the railways is laying special emphasis on enhancing the capacity of the corridor, he said.

The 'Chicken's Neck' is a narrow stretch of land -- about 20-22 km wide and nearly 60 km long -- in north Bengal that connects the northeastern states with the rest of India.

Shrivastava said once the projects are completed, the entire rail corridor will undergo a major transformation, and the area will develop in a more organised manner.

He said work on doubling the line in the Barsoi section was also underway, while infrastructure was being expanded across the Katihar division.

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, August 13

The Haryana Cabinet on Thursday approved the World Bank-funded Water Secure Haryana Programme (WSHP) at an estimated cost of Rs 5,714.80 crore, besides clearing a slew of measures to promote startups, particularly women-led ventures, and approving a Bill for setting up Masters Union University in Gurugram.

The integrated water-sector programme comprises a World Bank loan of Rs 4,000.36 crore and a state share of Rs 1,714.44 crore. It will cover 15 priority irrigation clusters with 48.94 lakh acres of irrigable command area and is expected to directly benefit around 45 lakh people.

The programme will focus on groundwater conservation, irrigation efficiency, water availability and sustainable agricultural water use. Measures such as Direct Seeded Rice and crop diversifi-



IT ALSO APPROVED A SLEW OF MEASURES TO PROMOTE STARTUPS, PARTICULARLY THOSE LED BY WOMEN

bursement for seven years.

The package includes assistance of up to Rs 10 lakh for technology licensing and transfer. Women-led startups in handicrafts, traditional textiles, environment-friendly rural products, Ayurveda-based wellness products and indigenous food products will receive micro-grants of Rs 50,000 to Rs 1 lakh.

For market access, general startups can receive up to Rs 5 lakh annually and women-led startups up to Rs 7 lakh for participation in domestic events and exhibitions. Startups can also claim 50 per cent reimbursement of quality certification costs, capped at Rs 25 lakh. The government will distribute 10,000 DIY kits to stu-

dents and establish H-HUB, a world-class incubator in collaboration with startups, corporates and educational institutions. Ten per cent of annual departmental procurement will be reserved for eligible Haryana-based startups.

The policy also provides matching grants of up to Rs 25 lakh against private or angel investment, apprenticeship stipend reimbursement of up to Rs 7,500 per apprentice per month, and 75 per cent reimbursement of cloud computing and storage costs, capped at Rs 2.5 lakh annually for five years.

The Cabinet also approved moving the Haryana Private Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2026 to facilitate Masters Union University in Gurugram. The university, promoted by Shanti Foundation Trust, is proposed on 5.14 acres with an existing 1,07,358-square-foot building. The trust holds the property on a 30-year lease.

What went wrong on Kanpur-Lucknow Expressway

Barely a month after opening, extensive repairs underway at several locations on expressway

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, August 13

Barely a month after opening, the Kanpur-Lucknow Expressway is undergoing extensive repairs at several locations, with road stretches being cut open and rebuilt, damaged shoulders being fixed and drains being reworked, raising questions over construction quality and pre-opening inspections.

A ground inspection found uneven road surfaces, cracks, drainage problems and signs of settlement near a bridge approach. The Uttar Pradesh Home Department has sought a status report from the National High-

ways Authority of India (NHAI). The most extensive repair work was found on the Kanpur-Lucknow carriageway between km 28 and 35, where machinery, aggregates and bitumen were stacked along nearly seven km. At several points, newly laid stretches were being cut open and reconstructed.

Drainage has also emerged as a concern. Up to km 37.6, drains at five locations were being broken and reworked to improve water discharge. In some places, crash barriers were blocking drains, potentially affecting water flow. Experts said inadequate drainage can weaken the soil beneath the pave-

KEY POINTS

- » Road stretches being cut open and rebuilt, damaged shoulders being fixed and drains being reworked
- » A ground inspection found uneven road surfaces, cracks, drainage problems and signs of settlement near a bridge approach



ment and damage the road surface. At km 39.5, workers were filling bridge cracks, while repair work at km 39.8 had reduced traffic to one lane. Three major patches were visible up to km 47, with uneven surfaces reported at several points.

A more serious issue was found near Niverna in

Unnao, where the bridge approach showed signs of settlement, with concrete blocks becoming uneven and shifting. Near Kantha village, about 200 metres of road had suffered damage. PNC Infratech, involved in construction, has stepped up repair work following complaints. PNC manager Satya Narayan

said there was no major problem near Niverna and attributed some defects to vehicle and construction machinery movement.

The Home Department has also sought details on whether the defects have implications for other PNC projects and whether the company has been debarred from

projects. NHAI officials said the matter was under consideration.

Meanwhile, several emergency telephone booths were found non-functional or unable to establish two-way communication with the control room, despite NHAI's assurance of assistance within 15 minutes. Service facilities too remain incomplete, with one site having a small restaurant and an under-construction building, while another has only land identified.

The early repairs have raised questions over quality checks before the expressway was opened and accountability for work now being redone.

Teen stages his abduction to pay online gaming debt

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Lucknow, August 13

A Class 11 student in Uttar Pradesh's Sant Kabir Nagar allegedly staged his own kidnapping to extract Rs 1 lakh from his businessman father after accumulating debt through online gaming, police said.

The teenager left home on Tuesday evening, telling his family he was going to Sikriganj in Gorakhpur. He instead switched off his mobile phone and hid at a friend's house. Around 7.39 pm, his father received a WhatsApp message claiming the boy had been kidnapped, followed by a Rs 1 lakh ransom demand. When the father offered to pay cash, the alleged kidnappers demanded Rs 2 lakh.

The businessman approached police, who traced the teenager using surveillance inputs and a digital trail from public Wi-Fi. He was found at his friend's house within about two-and-a-quarter hours. Police said the teenager had lost money through online gaming, exhausted his pocket money and borrowed from friends. He allegedly planned the kidnapping to repay the debt. To make the story convincing, he sent his father an AI-generated image depicting a badly injured eye. A female friend in Delhi allegedly helped create the image. The teenager was handed over to his father after questioning.

The case has also exposed how AI-generated images can be used to add credibility to fabricated emergencies. In this instance, the teenager's attempt to conceal his location failed because his use of public Wi-Fi left a digital trail.

EDITORIAL

Labels That Matter

The Supreme Court’s impatience with the prolonged delay in introducing front-of-pack warning labels on packaged foods is justified. Giving the Centre two weeks to take a final decision, the court has placed the debate where it belongs: on the consumer’s right to know what is being consumed. The issue concerns prominent warnings on products containing high levels of sugar, salt and saturated fat. India does not suffer from a shortage of information on food packets. The problem is how that information is presented. Nutrition tables printed in small type on the back of packages may satisfy disclosure requirements, but they are of limited use to consumers making purchasing decisions within seconds. Understanding serving sizes, recommended daily allowances and percentages requires both time and a degree of nutritional literacy. A simple warning on the front serves a different purpose: it communicates immediately.

This distinction becomes particularly important when children are involved. Attractive packaging, celebrity endorsements and claims suggesting health benefits can strongly influence purchasing behaviour. Parents should not have to scrutinise complicated tables to discover that a seemingly innocuous snack or drink contains unusually high quantities of sugar, salt or saturated fat. The Supreme Court has accordingly emphasised that consumer awareness and children’s health cannot remain hostage to regulatory indecision.

The debate has acquired greater significance because FSSAI has reportedly considered a nutrition-table approach rather than mandatory front-of-pack warnings. The regulator must certainly consult food manufacturers and consider implementation difficulties. Reformulation, packaging changes and compliance costs are legitimate considerations. But consultation cannot become an indefinite substitute for regulation. The food regulator’s principal obligation is to protect consumers, not to ensure that uncomfortable information remains unobtrusive. Nor should warning labels be viewed as an assault on consumer choice or the packaged-food industry. They prohibit nothing. Consumers remain free to purchase what they want, while manufacturers remain free to sell products meeting prescribed standards. What changes is the quality of information available at the moment of purchase. Informed choice is meaningful only when important information is visible and understandable.

There must, of course, be scientific rigour in determining thresholds. Foods cannot simply be divided into “good” and “bad” categories without considering quantities, composition and dietary context. The standards must be transparent, evidence-based and applied consistently. Manufacturers should also receive reasonable time to comply once regulations are finalised. But India has debated front-of-pack labelling for too long. The Supreme Court had already asked FSSAI earlier this year to seriously examine such warnings. Continued hesitation inevitably raises questions about regulatory priorities. The government should now use the court-imposed deadline to settle the matter. A citizen buying packaged food deserves to know, clearly and immediately, what lies inside. That is not excessive regulation. It is elementary consumer protection.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Power Emergency

Bangladesh’s prolonged power cuts expose the dangers of excessive dependence on imported fuel and inadequate energy security. Emergency diesel supplies may provide temporary relief, but lasting stability requires diversified energy sources, stronger infrastructure and careful planning to protect households, farmers and industries.

RAKIBUL HAQUE,
KOLKATA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Time to Recast NEET

Tougher laws can deter exam fraud, but lasting NEET reform requires an admission system that balances academic performance, aptitude, reasoning and equal opportunity

LEARNING CURVE



KDP RAO

THE WRITER IS A FORMER
ADDITIONAL CHIEF SECRETARY
OF CHHATTISGARH

Recently, in the wake of the NEET-UG paper leak agitations, the government has, inter alia, formed a high-powered task force, proposing to create a leak-proof examination system focusing on structural changes and robust data security protocols. Earlier, in 2024 as well, a seven-member high-level committee, with Dr Radhakrishnan as the chairman, was constituted to look into the conduct of exams by the NTA and suggest reforms.

Question paper leaks or the use of unfair means in our exam system are not new, but the red flag is about the increase in their frequency. The fallout is a double jeopardy: growing frustration among young aspirants, leading to depression, and erosion of institutional credibility. Unfortunately,

in spite of elaborate arrangements and reasonable precautions by state agencies, the possibility of the use of unfair means in exams always looms large, especially where there is cutthroat competition for limited seats in professional courses like NEET-UG.

Over the NEET-UG 2024 paper leak issue, a new law – ‘The Public Examinations (Prevention of Unfair Means) Act, 2024’ – was brought in, which, on account of another paper leak in NEET 2026, was amended in the current Parliament session last month, incorporating tougher jail terms, huge fines of up to 10 crore, and fast-track courts. The intent is definitely positive, and the new stringent clauses may act as a deterrent in the future. But can laws alone guarantee against the repetition of leaks and scams? Despite various laws in force, exam mafias continue to challenge the sanctity of exams in one way or another. So, the question is not ‘how’, but ‘why’ a paper leak happens. Exam scams are negative by-products of a draconian win-lose selection system originating in the narrative of meritocracy, which is meant more for elimination than selection. It is the main reason for criminal sabotage of the system by mafias, no matter how diligent or vigilant the state agencies are.

The solution lies less in stricter laws and more in a selection process that is equitable and inclusive. A multi-stage evaluation system, just as it exists in the UPSC ecosystem, where a long rope and breathing space are provided to candidates to improve their performance, can



Equitable and inclusive selection processes offer the solution

A SINGLE EXAMINATION SHOULD NOT BECOME THE SOLE MEASURE OF YEARS OF ACADEMIC ACHIEVEMENT

be the answer. The impregnability of the UPSC selection process is acknowledged by a hilarious meme on social media that, let alone the question papers, sometimes even the syllabus is not leaked.

The current NEET-UG system denies equity and inclusiveness – the two main pillars of modern education. Firstly, the entrance test is largely biased in favour of CBSE schools, whereas the vast majority of aspirants hail from State Boards. Secondly, the present system patronises the multi-million-dollar coaching industry, putting low-income-group aspirants at a disadvantage. The Rajan

Committee 2021 (TN) concluded that NEET disproportionately benefited repeaters (71% in 2021) and coached students (99% in 2020) and discriminated against first-time applicants. A fundamental question: Is it really necessary for aspirants to go through years of a self-mortifying, emotionally destabilising ordeal of rote learning in Kota or elsewhere to secure a seat in medical education? At least it wasn’t for legends like Dr Kotnis, Dr Jonas Salk (polio vaccine), Dr Mohammad Mashally or Dr Edward Jenner (smallpox), and many more.

The admission system in most Western countries focuses on selection rather than elimination. There exists neither a roaring coaching industry nor any ‘paper leak’ mafia. The University Clinical Aptitude Test (UCAT), followed by a consortium of universities in the United Kingdom, Singapore, Australia and New Zealand for medical and dental degree programmes, is only a test of aptitude and attitude and not of academic performance, which

the candidate already acquires at the A-Level (school-leaving qualification in the entire UK). UCAT assesses behavioural attributes and mental abilities such as critical thinking, logical reasoning and inference. The International Medical Admission Test (IMAT) in Italy is also a test of aptitude. It has 20 questions on logical reasoning and general knowledge, and 40 on the candidate’s ability to apply scientific knowledge from school science. The Medical College Admission Test (MCAT) in the US, Australia and Canada is a medical ability test offered by the Association of American Medical Colleges (AAMC), whose chances of cracking are said to be 50%, compared to 5-7% for NEET.

Merit is not being but opportunity, which, again, is a combination of access, equality and inclusion. Selection solely on the basis of a single entrance test is only to disregard years of academic achievement in school. The admission process should be more like a marathon rather than a hundred-metre dash, so that aspirants from diverse backgrounds can have enough space to prove their mettle. We need a better alternative. A system of comprehensive evaluation giving equal importance to school performance, aptitude, reasoning skills and behavioural attitudes will offer a level playing field. Entrance tests are welcome, but only as a part (of a qualifying nature), just as the CSAT is in the UPSC. Such an overarching admission policy leaves little or no room for any unfair practices. The high-powered task force may like to mull over it.

Views expressed are personal

A Generation Speaks Up

Student activism reflects growing anxieties over examinations, education, jobs and economic security

YOUNG INDIA



JOHN FELIX RAJ &
PRABHAT KUMAR DATTA

JF RAJ IS THE VC, PK DATTA IS
AN ADJUNCT PROFESSOR AT ST
XAVIER’S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

immense pressure on families who often secure loans to invest in higher education.

Despite a gradual shift in overall demographics, India’s young population—comprising 367 million individuals between the ages of 15 and 29—represents the largest Generation Z cohort in the world. Maximising this demographic dividend is essential for realising national development goals, including the vision of Viksit Bharat.

However, psychological and social well-being remain key priorities; research from Krea University’s Sapien Labs Centre for the Human Brain and Mind indicates that over half of Indian youth aged 18-24 experience notable emotional or socio-economic stress.

Core Concerns of Contemporary Students

Student movements in India have evolved over time. During the colonial era, students rallied against imperial rule. In the 1970s, youth participation was central to broader social movements, such as the Jayaprakash Narayan movement, which focused on governance reform, and local movements reflecting regional aspirations, such as those in Assam.

Today’s student discussions centre heavily on institutional transparency, governance, and systemic fairness. Key issues include:

- **Examination Integrity:** Demand for fair, leak-free, and merit-based administrative processes.
- **Educational Standards:** Concerns regarding quality maintenance across public higher education institutions amid expanding private offerings.
- **Economic Security:** A growing need for alignment between academic curricula and stable employment opportunities.

Unlike the ideological shifts of the past, contemporary student concerns are largely



The new generation is transforming student activism across India

FROM EXAM INTEGRITY TO JOBS AND INSTITUTIONAL TRANSPARENCY, INDIA’S STUDENTS ARE INCREASINGLY MAKING THEIR CONCERNS CENTRAL TO DEMOCRATIC AND POLICY CONVERSATIONS

issue-driven and non-sectarian. Young people seek administrative fairness and systemic efficiency, viewing a transparent education system as the primary engine for social mobility.

Global Context and Socio-Economic Realities

The dynamic between students and educational institutions takes place against a complex economic backdrop. Global economic adjustments—following post-pandemic disruptions, international trade shifts, and geopolitical tensions—present systemic challenges for economies worldwide. In India, balancing public expenditure on higher education while fostering institutional growth requires continuous policy attention.

Significantly, Generation Z brings a unique profile to civic dialogue. As hyper-cognitive digital natives, their patterns of

learning, communication, and engagement differ from those of previous generations. Recognising this shift, various political and civic organisations across the spectrum have increasingly sought dialogue with young people to better understand their perspectives and generational concerns.

Fostering Dialogue and Building Trust

Students have a natural interest in the institutional decisions that shape their academic and professional futures. Viewing these concerns through a constructive lens offers an opportunity for productive engagement. Fostering trust between institutions, governance bodies, and the youth requires empathetic listening, transparent communication, and responsive policy measures.

A collaborative approach is essential for converting

demographic potential into practical progress:

- **Constructive Engagement:** Institutional leadership and policymakers benefit from maintaining open platforms for peaceful student feedback.
- **Policy Inclusion:** Involving young perspectives in educational planning ensures that reform initiatives remain aligned with market realities and student needs.

Gen Z and Civic Participation

The present century has been termed the century of change. This era is marked by accelerating technological advancements, globalisation, and climate crises. Amidst this volatile but promising terrain, one demographic has emerged as the most potent agent of change—the youth. We have learnt from history that each period of advancement, be it scientific, cultural, or political, has been spurred substantially by the energy, imagination, and valour of young people.

By 2029, Generation Z is projected to number nearly 380 million, forming the largest adult demographic in the country. Their digital fluency, combined with evolving expectations regarding governance and career infrastructure, equips them to play an active role in civic life.

Currently, formal legislative representation among the youth remains modest relative to their population size. Gen Z accounts for over a quarter of the country’s population, yet its representation in politics is restricted to just 26 legislators across the country—six Lok Sabha MPs and 20 MLAs. As scholar Philip Altbach observed, student political awareness and participation can constructively contribute to nation-building, civic awareness, and social progress by highlighting fundamental institutional questions. Integrating the insights of Generation Z into policy discussions ensures that India’s youth are active partners in shaping the nation’s future.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Romania begins shutdown of nuclear plant's 2nd reactor

BUCHAREST: Romania on Thursday began a controlled shutdown of the second reactor at its Cernavoda nuclear power plant as a severe drought continues to grip the continent.

Scorching heat and low rainfall in recent weeks have left the Danube River at record lows and forced the state-owned Cernavoda plant to shut down its first reactor in late July. The plant accounts for about 20 per cent of the country's electricity generation when fully operational and uses river water to cool its two reactors.

Ukraine's drones hit Russian refinery deep inside Russia

KYIV: Ukrainian drones struck a major refinery deep inside Russia, military officials said Thursday, the fourth in three days in Kyiv's monthslong campaign to choke Moscow's vital oil sector.

Russia is one of the world's biggest energy producers, with oil providing an economic mainstay as its army tries to push deeper into Ukraine in a slow and costly advance more than four years after Moscow launched its full-scale invasion. The attacks have dented Russia's refining capacity, bringing shortages at gas stations.

B'desh: Mirza Fakhrul set to be the BNP's Prez candidate

DHAKA: The ruling Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) on Thursday nominated its secretary general Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir as its candidate for the country's presidency, setting the stage for his election as the next head of state. The presidential election will be held on August 20.

The 78-year-old veteran politician resigned as BNP secretary general and from its highest policy-making standing committee after being nominated, senior joint secretary general Ruhul Kabir Rizvi announced.



Seen in a long exposure, the Bug Fire burns near Doyle in unincorporated Lassen County on Thursday

AP/PTI

Ebola outbreak spread to new province in Congo

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kinshasa, August 13

Congo's Ebola outbreak has spread to a sixth province, after a death was recorded in the previously unaffected Bas-Uele province, Africa CDC Director-General Jean Kaseya said Thursday.

Kaseya said the infected person had travelled from Isiro in Haut-Uele province to Buta, the capital of Bas-Uele, where the person died.

The outbreak in eastern Congo, considered the fastest-growing one yet, is on track to surpass the deadliest one in history, which erupted over a decade ago and killed over 11,000 people, the World Health Organisation said.

US-IRAN TALKS HIT DEAD END

No progress on reviving interim deal with US: Iran

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, August 13

Iran and the United States remain at loggerheads over efforts to agree a permanent end to the war in the Gulf, according to a senior Iranian source, who said there had been no progress in talks to revive the interim deal agreed in June and define a time frame to implement it.

The comments came as US President Donald Trump issued yet another broadside against Iran's leaders, dealing a further blow to hopes for a resolution to the crisis, following new attacks on shipping in the region on Tuesday.

The deal agreed in June declared an "immediate and permanent



Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi

termination of military operations on all fronts", but quickly unravelled, with Trump saying it was "over" on July 7 and Iran's foreign ministry declaring it "suspended" a week later.

Meanwhile, US war with Iran has quickly become one of the most

unpopular wars in United States history.

At the beginning of March 2026, when the war started, 46 per cent of Americans opposed the conflict, according to pollster Nate Silver's aggregator of polling data. Now that number has risen to 57 per cent.

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Agreement struck in June has swiftly unravelled
- » Both sides accuse each other of failing to stick to terms
- » Strait of Hormuz remains closed

As a result, US President Donald Trump is in urgent need of reliable support for the war effort. A group known as Christian Zionists consistently shows strong backing for his military actions.

Foremost among these supporters are those who gathered for the Christians United for Israel (CUFI) annual conference recently held in Washington, DC.

US envoy calls Israeli settler siege of West Bank homes ‘act of terror’

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Jerusalem, August 13

The US Ambassador to Israel condemned the actions of Jewish settlers who are besieging the home of an American Palestinian family in the Israeli-occupied West Bank.

US Ambassador Mike Huckabee called the siege a "horrific act of terror."

Since Sunday, according to local officials and family members, settlers have gathered near the home in the village of Qusra and harassed those inside, defying efforts by the Israeli military to defuse the situation.

A group that has included up to dozens of men has thrown stones, attempted to bring down a stone wall nearby, and prevented the occupants from leaving despite dwindling supplies.

Speaking to The Associated Press by phone



Representational Image

A GROUP THAT HAS INCLUDED UP TO DOZENS OF MEN HAS THROWN STONES, ATTEMPTED TO BRING DOWN A STONE WALL NEARBY

from his home in Ohio, the home's owner Lou Ridi said his 48-year-old brother and nephew, who have been holed up in the

home to defend it, had been unable to leave the house and did not have access to food or water for several days.

On Thursday morning, the owner's brother Quasai Abu Rida said that he and his teenage son had been evacuated by Israel's military. It was unclear what would happen to the property and at least one other that has been targeted.

Israeli troops intervened in recent days to try to restore order.

B'desh goes dark as it battles worst power crisis, turns to India for help

AGENCIES

Dhaka, August 13

Bangladesh is grappling with one of its most severe energy crises, with several parts of the country experiencing excessive power outages.

The situation has become so acute that the government has directed shopping malls, shops and markets to shut down by 8 pm to conserve electricity. Businesses, farmers and industries have also been hit by the worsening power crunch.

To tide over the crisis, Bangladesh has turned to India, seeking additional

“THE POWER CRUNCH IS BEING FELT PARTICULARLY IN RURAL AREAS OUTSIDE THE CAPITAL

diesel supplies.

The power crunch is being felt particularly in rural areas outside the capital, Dhaka, with outages stretching to 8-10 hours, according to local reports. The sweltering heat and the ongoing heatwave have only added to the woes. Factor this: while demand has hovered around 18,000 MW, the

supply has struggled to reach 13,000 MW. The excessive load-shedding, which has been going on for days, has prompted frustrated residents to attack electricity facilities in some areas, according to a report in Dhaka Tribune.

It has forced the Bangladesh Palli Bidyt Association to seek police security for grids, substations and electricity offices. Over the past few days, local police stations have received letters from electricity cooperatives seeking deployment of police and regular night patrols at power installations.

PoK: JAAC abducted 8 policemen on poll duty

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Islamabad, August 13

Police in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir on Thursday accused the banned Joint Awami Action Committee (JAAC) of abducting eight highway police personnel who were on election duty.

Police spokesperson Khawar Ali Shaukat told

the media that the JAAC attacked security forces deputed on election duty in the region.

"Eight highway police officials on election duty were abducted," he claimed. He said that the abducted personnel were in the custody of JAAC and alleged that they had been subjected to "brutal abuse".

Canadian deadly wildfire may signal ‘new normal’

The fire forced 20,000 to flee

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Penticton, August 13

Penticton (British Columbia), Aug 13 (AP) A wildfire that forced more than 20,000 people from their homes in western Canada moved so quickly that crews had to abandon fire-fighting to help residents escape, a pace British Columbia's premier said Wednesday may represent a "new normal."

The Bald Range wildfire erupted Friday near Summerland, a community of about 12,000 in British Columbia's Okanagan region.

By Wednesday, it had grown to about 184 square kilometers (71 square miles) after destroying homes and killing an 80-year-old woman.

"There's an important set of lessons for us to take about how quickly this moved and that this may be our new normal for

fire speed," Premier David Eby said.

He said the blaze outpaced wildfire modeling and left some residents with little time to evacuate.

Officials have begun damage assessments, but the area remained unsafe Wednesday and there was no timeline for residents to return.

Crews were clearing vegetation to help slow the fire's spread as officials warned that thunderstorms could bring erratic winds and increase fire activity.

Highway 97, a major route through the area, remained closed.

Eby visited an evacuation reception center in Penticton, where he said he met people devastated by the loss of their homes.

"A lot of emotions in there, obviously," he told reporters, calling the woman's death a "tragic loss."

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Extract of Unaudited Financial Results for the Quarter ended 30/06/2026				
Sr. No.	Particulars	Quarter Ending 30/06/2026	Year to Date Figures 31/03/2026	Corresponding Three Months Ended in the Previous Year 30.06.2025
1	Total Income	258.30	662.91	164.55
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	-51.55	332.61	76.98
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	-51.55	332.61	76.98
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	-51.55	244.46	57.71
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	-51.55	244.46	57.71
6	Equity Share Capital	6340.41	6340.41	330.00
7	Reserves & Surplus (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year	-----	4097.56	-----
8	Face Value of Equity Share Capital	10/-	10/-	10/-
9	Earnings Per Share (Basic / Diluted)	-0.08	0.39	0.17
Note: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarter Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites i.e. www.bseindia.com and www.msse.in				
For, Corporate Merchant Bankers Limited, Place : Ahmedabad				
Sd/- Vishal Jethalal Nayak • Managing Director - DIN:11048209				

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)						
The Executive Engineer, Shimla Urban Division, HPFWD, Shimla-3 on behalf of Governor of HP invites the percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system, from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPFWD, for the work as detailed in the table.						
Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Starting date for downloading Bid	EMD	Cost of Tender	Time
1	Construction of Vehicular Underpass Near Lift.	Rs. 26563674.00	13-08-2026	Rs. 531273.00	Rs. 2000.00	Six Months
The bidders are advised to note other details, of tenders from the department website, www.hptenders.gov.in. The Executive Engineer reserves the right to accept/reject any tender/application without assigning any reason.						
Ro.No 2621/2026-2027						

Government of Union Territory Jammu & Kashmir OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MECHANICAL AND HOSPITALS DIVISION SRINAGAR						
Telefax:- 0194-2496089, Email ID:- exen-mechospgr@jk.gov.in NIT No: M&HDS/TS/2026-27/47/e-tendering Dated:-12.08.2026						
For and on behalf of the Lt. Governor, J&K UT e-tenders are invited on percentage basis from registered/reputed/experienced firms with J&K State Govt., CPWD, Railways and other State/Central Governments for the below mentioned work:						
Name of Work	Est. Cost (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of T/Doc. (In rupees)	Time of completion (in days)	AA Accorded Vide No:	TS No	Earnest Money
1. Providing Comprehensive Maintenance Contract (CMC) for One (01) Year (12 Calendar Months) Of (G+3) 26 Passenger Staircase OTIS Make Lift Installed At Govt. Super Speciality hospital, Srinagar	1.10	100	365	07 MCS of 2026 Dt:23.04.2026	M&HDS/TS/35of	5% of the estimate cost
2. Providing Comprehensive Maintenance Contract (CMC) for One (01) Year (12 Calendar Months) Of 20 Passenger (G+4) OTIS Make Lift Installed At MRI Building, Opposite Staircase, Govt. Super Speciality Hospital, Srinagar	1.22	100	10	07 MCS of 2026 Dt:23.04.2026	02 of 06/26 (Sd 1st)	5% of the estimate cost
1.Downloading of Bids:- The NIT consisting of qualifying information, eligibility criteria, specifications, Bill of quantities (B.O.Q), Set of terms and conditions of contract and other details can be seen from the departmental website www.jktenders.gov.in from 12.08.2026(18.00hrs)and can be downloaded from 12.08.2026 (18.00hrs) 2.Uploading: The bidders shall deposit their bids in electronic format on the above web site 12.08.2026(18.00hrs) to 24.08.2026 (13.00hrs) in two (02) covers. 3.Opening of Bids :- The bids received upto due date and time shall be opened on 24.08.2026 at 15.00(hrs) No: M&HDS/TS/2055-59 DIP No:DIPK-4505/26						
Sd/- Executive Engineer, M&HD, Srinagar						

millenniumpost

CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

I hitherto known as Pankaj Kumar S/o Bhagat Singh Malik, R/o H.No.-114, Indra Colony, Narela, Delhi-110040, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Pankaj Kumar Malik.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform public in general that Kotak Mahindra bank Ltd has organized an auction in below mention respect of Vehicles. VEHICLES FOR SALE

1) MARUTIS SUPCARYCNG REG. NO. DL1LAM6667- YOM- NA

UNDER HYPOTHECATION WITH M/S KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK IS UNDER SALE IN ITS "AS IS WHERE IS CONDITION" INTERESTED PARTIES CAN GIVE THEIR QUOTATIONS WITH IN 7 DAYS AT BRANCH ADDRESS: KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. 3RD FLOOR, PLOT NO 7, SECTOR 125, NOIDA-201313 OR CONTACT : PUNIT PARASHAR KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK LTD. CONTACT NO. . 8377905498 EMAIL:punit.parashar@kotak.com

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Notice Inviting Tender

Tender is invited for empanelment of agencies for repair of defective Power Transformer (PTRs) of various capacity (e.g. 5MVA, 10 MVA etc.) on rate contract under JBVNL.

Sl. No	NIT No.	Description	Estimated value (incl. GST Rs.) (In Crs.)	EMD value (Incl. GST) (Rs. In lacs.)	Tender Cost (Incl. GST) (In Rs.)	Downloading/ Sale of Tender Document	Pre-Bid Meeting	Last date of sale of tender document	Last Date of submission of bid	Date of Opening of Tender
1	212/PR/JBVNL/2026-27	Empanelment of agencies for repair of defective Power Transformer (PTRs) of various capacity (e.g. 5MVA, 10 MVA etc.) on rate contract under JBVNL.	8.13	16.26	11,800	14.08.26	21.08.26 at 3.00 PM	04.09.26 Up to 05:00PM	04.09.26 Up to 06:00PM	07.09.26 Up to 05:00PM

Further details against the above Tender can be obtained from website http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in and may be contacted on Mobile No. 9066819264/ 8709711244 & NIC helpline No. 0651-2400178, Email ID:- gm.stn@jbvnl.co.in . Submission of bid document fee and EMD will be accepted through online mode only and receipt/acknowledgement of tender submission of the same should be submitted to the office of undersigned on or before 07.09.2026.

स्वहित एवं राष्ट्रहित में कर्जा बचावें। कृपया अपनी शिकायतों को टॉल फ्री नं० 1800 345 6570 पर दर्ज करायें।

PR 387421 (Jharkhand Bijlee Vitran Nigam Ltd) 26-27 (D)

Sd/- General Manager (DN) JBVNL

News at a glance

Gold loses steam after 7-day rally, prices fall by ₹2,800

NEW DELHI: Gold ended a seven-session rally on Thursday, with prices falling by Rs 2,800 to Rs 1,57,000 per 10 grams in the national capital amid a weak trend in global markets.

The yellow metal of 999 per cent purity had closed at Rs 1,59,800 per 10 grams on Wednesday.

Silver also faced an even steeper sell-off, tumbling Rs 6,000 to Rs 2,40,000 per kilogram, according to the All India Sarafa Association.

The white metal had settled at Rs 2,46,000 per kg in the preceding session.

Tata Motors PV Q1 net profit plunges 78.54% to Rs 859 cr

MUMBAI: Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles on Thursday reported a 78.54 per cent decline in net profit to Rs 859 crore in Q1FY27, hit by supply chain disruptions and elevated commodity costs.

Revenue rose 9 per cent year-on-year to Rs 95,799 crore. JLR wholesales fell 9.2 per cent due to supply constraints, the West Asia conflict and planned Jaguar wind-down. Domestic revenue grew 65 per cent, while PV volumes surged 46 per cent and EV volumes 112 per cent. The company said strong demand and new launches should support growth.

Black Box bags \$131 mn US order for data centre project

MUMBAI: Black Box Ltd has secured a \$131 million (Rs 1,240 crore) order from a new US-based global Tier-1 hyperscaler for a major data centre project in the US.

The win marks a breakthrough in the company's US hyperscaler business and adds a new marquee customer to its portfolio.

It will execute the project at a key US location over about three years, with scope for further expansion. The order was secured through its domain expertise and phased execution approach.

Fire at ONGC installation in Kalol brought under control

NEW DELHI: A minor fire was reported at an ONGC installation in the Kalol Field on Thursday morning, the company said. ONGC's Fire and Emergency Response teams promptly responded and extinguished the blaze.

No injuries or harm to personnel were reported. The situation is fully under control, with normal production operations restored, ONGC said. The company added that it remains committed to maintaining robust safety standards and emergency-response preparedness across its operational locations.

Briefs

Rupee falls 12 paise to 95.45/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 12 paise to 95.45 against the US dollar on Thursday, weighed by weak domestic markets and persistent foreign fund outflows.

At the interbank forex, rupee opened at 95.40 against the greenback and traded in a range of 95.35-95.48. It settled at 95.45, down 12 paise from previous close.

Shiprocket IPO gets 3.16x bids

NEW DELHI: The initial public offering of e-commerce enabling platform Shiprocket Ltd was subscribed 3.16 times on the second day of bidding on Thursday.

The Rs 1,617.5-crore IPO received bids for 29,82,12,684 shares against 9,44,36,030 shares on offer, as per NSE data.

The category for retail investors was subscribed 9.76 times, while the non-institutional investors segment drew 4.84 times subscription.

Lenovo India revenue rises 18% in Q1

NEW DELHI: Lenovo India on Thursday reported an 18 per cent year-on-year growth in revenue for the first quarter ended June 30, 2026, driven by strong demand for AI integrated solutions.

The company, however, did not disclose the specific revenue figure for its India operations. On a global level, total revenue reached \$26.9 billion, up 43 per cent from \$18.8 billion in the same quarter of the previous fiscal.

Baroda BNP Paribas Mutual Fund appoints Madhu Nair as CEO

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 13

Baroda BNP Paribas Asset Management India has appointed Madhu Nair as its new Chief Executive Officer (CEO), as the fund house seeks to scale up its presence in India's rapidly expanding mutual fund industry.

The appointment comes as the industry's average assets under management (AAUM) crossed Rs 86.33 lakh crore at the end of July 2026.

Baroda BNP Paribas Asset Management's AAUM also crossed Rs 57,000 crore as of July 31.

Madhu Nair succeeds Sanjay Kumar Grover, Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (CEO), who was on deputation from Bank of Baroda and led the organisation through a significant growth phase.

The fund house said the leadership change reflects its ambition to emerge as a scaled, purpose-led player.

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 13

Larsen & Toubro (L&T) on Thursday said it has secured a Rs 10,000-15,000 crore 'mega' order to build the country's largest single-cluster artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure facility, marking its entry into the AI Factory business.

Through LTN Compute and Vyoma.AI, L&T will set up an NVIDIA B300-based AI Factory at its Chennai data centre campus for US-based Together AI. The

facility, with 10,000 NVIDIA B300 GPUs, will support large-scale AI inference, fine-tuning and training workloads.

Vyoma's Chennai campus is designed as a gigawatt-scale AI infrastructure site, with Phase 1 capacity

of 250 MW and 150 MVA power infrastructure readiness. L&T said the project will strengthen India's AI infrastructure ecosystem and support global innovation.

The company said the exact order value has not

TO ENSURE SUSTAINABILITY OF PAYMENTS ECOSYSTEM

Parl Panel seeks swift introduction of MDR on high-value transactions

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 13

A Parliamentary Panel has recommended expeditious introduction of a calibrated Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on high-value transactions to ensure the financial sustainability of the payments ecosystem and reduce the burden on the exchequer.

The Standing Committee on Finance, in its report tabled on Wednesday, also recommended that the Department of Financial Services, under the Ministry of Finance, enforce stringent monitoring to prevent idle parking of funds under the Pradhan Mantri Vaya Vandana Yojana (PMVVY) and the Atal Pension Yojana (APY), while evaluating the long-term financial sustainability of defined-benefit and incentive schemes.

Regarding the incentive scheme for the promotion of RuPay Debit Cards and low-value BHIM-UPI transactions, the Committee expressed concern that providing a Rs 2,000 crore budgetary allocation



EARLIER THIS WEEK, PARLIAMENT PASSED A BILL TO AMEND THE PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEMS ACT, 2007

KEY POINTS

- » It allows govt to permit banks & other service providers to levy charges on payments via UPI, other notified e-payment modes
- » Govt's approach aims to levy a small charge on digital payment services for consumers, small bizs and ensure a sustainable revenue model for banks, PSPs
- » The committee also recommended enforcing stringent monitoring to prevent idle parking of funds under PMVVY & APY

to offset zero-MDR losses needlessly inflates the Department's overall Demand for Grants, while covering only about 10 per cent of actual operational costs.

The Committee had, therefore, recommended that the Department explore a self-reliant, tiered revenue mechanism to ensure financial sustainability without perpetually straining the exchequer.

The report stated that, in pursuance of their earlier

recommendation emphasising the importance of a viable revenue model, enabling legislative provisions for a tiered MDR structure were brought forward.

However, the Committee headed by senior BJP leader Bhartruhari Mahtab expressed concern over the staggering mismatch between the Rs 2,000 crore allocation and the industry's estimated operational cost of Rs 20,700 crore.

While statutory enablement now exists to permit calibrated MDR on high-value transactions, any delay in notifying and operationalising this framework leaves payment service providers heavily dependent on inadequate subsidies, thereby threatening critical investments in cybersecurity, fraud prevention, and network infrastructure, the report said.

"The Committee, therefore, reiterates the recommendation to expedite the implementation of a self-reliant, tiered revenue framework for higher-value merchant transactions while safeguarding small merchants and P2P transfers, thereby transitioning the digital payments ecosystem to a self-sustaining model," the report said.

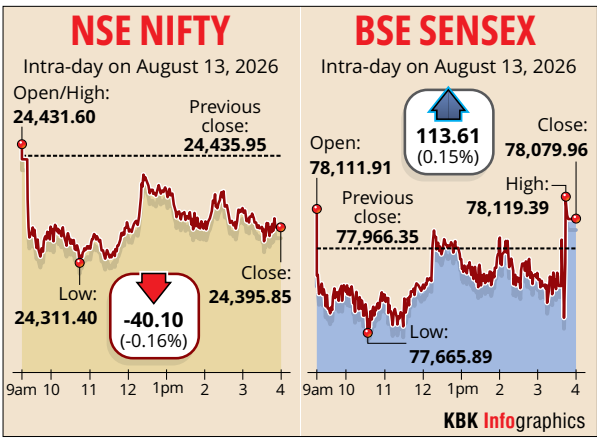
Earlier this week, Parliament passed a Bill to amend the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, that authorises the government to permit banks and other service providers to levy charges on payments through Unified Payments Interface (UPI) and other notified

electronic payment modes.

The amendments approved by Parliament seek to remove the existing legal provision that prevents banks and payment service providers from charging MDR on notified electronic payment modes.

The government's approach aims to levy a small charge on digital payment services for consumers and small businesses while ensuring a sustainable revenue model for banks, payment service providers (PSPs), and payment infrastructure firms that drive the digital payments ecosystem.

The Bill seeks to make changes in Section 10A of the Payment and Settlement Systems Act, 2007, which prohibits banks and system providers from imposing any charges on electronic payments, and Section 269SU of the Income Tax Act requires large businesses with a turnover exceeding Rs 50 crore to accept payments through specific electronic modes, including RuPay debit cards and BHIM-UPI QR codes.



OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 13

Benchmark indices ended mixed on Thursday, with the Sensex rising nearly 114 points and the Nifty sliding over 40 points, as elevated crude prices and geopolitical uncertainty made investors cautious.

Fag-end buying helped the BSE Sensex to end the session in the positive territory. The 30-share index settled 113.61 points, or 0.15 per cent, higher at 78,079.96.

During the day, the benchmark hit a high of 78,119.39 and a low of 77,665.89, gyrating 453.5 points.

The 50-share NSE Nifty was marginally down 40.10 points, or 0.16 per cent, to end at 24,395.85, registering its third day of decline.

From the Sensex pack, InterGlobe Aviation, NTPC, Bharat Electronics, Larsen & Toubro, Hindustan Unilever and Eternal were

among the winners. ICICI Bank, Titan, Reliance Industries, UltraTech Cement and Infosys were among the major laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, declined 1.44 per cent to USD 87.70 per barrel.

The BSE MidCap Select index climbed 0.53 per cent and the SmallCap Select index was up 0.35 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, Realty jumped 1.46 per cent, FMCG 0.97 per cent, Services 0.89 per cent, Industrials 0.83 per cent, Focused IT 0.65 per cent, IT 0.49 per cent and Utilities 0.31 per cent.

Metal dropped 0.97 per cent, Commodities 0.51 per cent, Insurance 0.50 per cent, Top 10 Banks 0.24 per cent, Energy 0.23 per cent and Private Banks index 0.22 per cent.

FIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 1,002.50 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



PSPCL women officers & spouses celebrate Teej with traditional Punjabi attire, folk songs & Giddha at the Officers' Club in Patiala. The traditional outfits and vibrant decorations added color to the celebrations.

Petronet LNG's Q1 PAT rises 33% to ₹1,133 cr

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 13

Petronet LNG Ltd reported a 33 per cent growth in standalone profit before tax (PBT) to Rs 1,514 crore in Q1FY27 from Rs 1,136 crore in Q1FY26. Standalone profit after tax (PAT) also rose 33 per cent to Rs 1,133 crore from Rs 851 crore.

Dahej terminal processed 192 TBTU of LNG during the April-June quarter, against 207 TBTU in the corresponding quarter last year and 201 TBTU in the previous quarter. Overall LNG volumes processed

stood at 207 TBTU, compared with 220 TBTU and 219 TBTU, respectively.

Dahej terminal's capacity utilisation stood at 66 per cent, against 92 per cent a year ago and 90 per cent in the previous quarter. Overall company utilisation was 58 per cent, compared with 76 per cent in both periods.

Following the regasification expansion, Dahej's nameplate capacity increased to 22.5 MMTPA from 17.5 MMTPA. The company attributed the financial growth to commercial and operational efficiency.

IMPORTS ROSE BY ABOUT 17.52% TO \$76.22 BILLION IN JULY

India's exports surge 19.6% in July, trade deficit widens to \$31.98 billion

OUR CORRESPONDENT

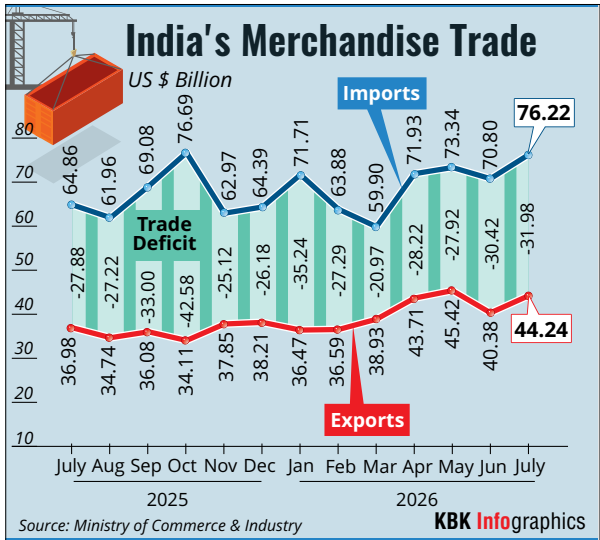
New Delhi, August 13

The country's merchandise exports surged 19.63 per cent to \$44.24 billion in July, driven by a jump in shipments of petroleum products, while higher imports pushed the trade deficit to a six-month high of \$31.98 billion.

Imports rose by about 17.52 per cent year-on-year to \$76.22 billion in July due to increase in the inbound shipments of crude oil, which grew by 17.64 per cent to \$18.31 billion, according to the data released by the commerce ministry on Thursday.

Brent crude oil prices ranged between \$72 and \$95 per barrel during July. Crude oil imports accounted for about 24 per cent of the total imports during the month.

The growth in exports in July was the highest since June 2022, when



shipments had risen 30.12 per cent.

During April-July this fiscal, exports jumped 17.04 per cent to \$173.78 billion, and imports climbed 19.27 per cent to \$292.38 billion.

Merchandise trade deficit during April-July 2026-27 widened to \$118.60 billion as compared to

\$96.66 billion during April-July 2025-26. In July 2025, the deficit was \$27.88 billion. In June it was \$30.43 billion.

Inbound shipments of raw cotton, pulses, fertiliser, coal and coke, chemical material, project goods, gold, and electronics too pushed the country's

KEY POINTS

» During April-July this fiscal, exports jumped 17.04% to \$173.78 billion, and imports climbed 19.27 per cent to \$292.38 billion

» Merchandise trade deficit during April-July FY27 widened to \$118.60 bn as against \$96.66 bn in April-July 2025-26. In July 2025, the deficit was \$27.88 bn. In June it was \$30.43 bn

» The growth in exports in July was the highest since June 2022, when shipments had risen 30.12 per cent

import bill during the last month.

Electronics, project goods and gold imports grew by 46 per cent to \$14.4 billion, about 180 per cent to \$90.64 million, and 4 per cent to about \$4.16 billion, respectively, in July.

Briefing the media on the data, Commerce Secre-

tary Rajesh Agarwal attributed the increase in the country's outbound shipments to higher exports of petroleum products, electronics, engineering and marine goods.

The main countries where India's exports recorded a jump in shipments include the US, Singapore, China, South Africa, Tanzania and Malaysia.

He also said India's exports to West Asian countries rose 8.62 per cent to \$5.7 billion in July.

During the last month, petroleum products, electronics, and engineering shipments grew by 67.64 per cent to about \$7 billion, 57.4 per cent to about \$6 billion, and 17.7 per cent to about \$12.24 billion.

Meanwhile, as per government estimates, services exports stood at \$35.89 billion in July, and imports were \$18.94 billion.

CIL, L&T among 20 cos bidding for rare earth magnet scheme

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 13

Coal India and Larsen & Toubro are among 20 companies that have submitted bids under the Rs 7,280-crore scheme for setting up integrated Sintered NdFeB Rare Earth Permanent Magnet (REPM) manufacturing facilities in India, signalling strong industry interest in the government's push to build a domestic REPM manufacturing ecosystem.

The Ministry of Heavy Industries (MHI) received 20 bids through a global tender on the central public procurement (CPP) portal for selection of manufacturers under the "Scheme to Promote Manufacturing of Sintered Rare Earth Permanent Magnet (REPM)". The technical bids were opened on August 13 in the presence of the bidders at MHI.

Apart from Coal India Limited and Larsen & Toubro, the other bidders include 20 Microns, Attero Recycling, BaRupOn-IRP Consortium, Jay Fe Cylinders, Keystone Infra Pvt. Ltd-Huebox Interiors Pvt.



Ltd. (JV), Lohum Magnets & Energy Solutions, Midwest Energy Limited-Midwest Advanced Materials (JV), N.A.N. Magnetech and NEO Performance Materials (Singapore) PTE. LTD.

The remaining bidders are Nexon Geochem Private Limited, PrNd Metal and Magnets, Proterial (India) Ltd, Prozeal Green Energy, Ramp Metals & Minerals, Renew Private Ltd, Shankaranarayana Constructions, Solpro Greentech and Starteck Finance.

The Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, approved the "Scheme to Promote Manufacturing of Sintered Rare Earth Permanent Magnet (REPM)" on November 26, 2025, with a financial outlay of Rs 7,280 crore. The scheme notification

was issued by MHI on December 15, 2025.

The Request For Proposal (RFP) was floated on the CPP portal on March 20, 2026, and the pre-bid conference was held on April 7, 2026. The last date for receiving bids was August 12, 2026.

The first-of-its-kind scheme aims to establish a total capacity of 6,000 Metric Tons Per Annum (MTPA) of integrated Rare Earth Permanent Magnet manufacturing facilities in India, thereby enhancing self-reliance and positioning India as a key player in the global REPM market.

The scheme envisions allocating the total capacity to five beneficiaries through a global competitive bidding process. Each beneficiary will be allotted up to 1,200 MTPA of capacity.

The total duration of the scheme will be 7 years from the date of award, including a 2-year gestation period for setting up an integrated REPM manufacturing facility, and 5 years for incentive disbursement on the sale of REPM.

Tata Trusts starts selection process to find Chandrasekaran's successor to lead Tata Sons

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, August 13

The Tata Trusts on Thursday initiated the process of finding N Chandrasekaran's successor to lead the diversified conglomerate's holding company, Tata Sons.

"The Sir Dorabji Tata Trust (SDTT) respects Chandrasekaran's decision not to offer himself for re-

appointment. We place on record our deepest appreciation for his contribution and stewardship of Tata Sons and the Tata group over the past decade," a statement from the Trusts, which hold nearly two-thirds of Tata Sons, said.

Specifically, the Trusts thanked Chandrasekaran's contributions

during the period of "significant change, growth and transformation" across the group. In a sudden move, Chandrasekaran on Wednesday said he would not seek reappointment as the Tata Sons Chairman for a third term due to a lack of unanimity on the issue within the board.

The Tata Trusts statement issued on Thursday

said Trustees of the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust have passed a resolution to initiate the setting up of a selection committee as soon as possible "in accordance with the Articles of Association of Tata Sons, for the purpose of recommending a person for appointment as the new Chairman of the Board of Directors."

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, August 13

MSCI has added Adani Energy Solutions, Billionbrains Garage Ventures, Laurus Labs and Lenskart Solutions to its India Domestic Index tracks Indian stocks selected under MSCI's methodology and is used by global investors to monitor segments of the Indian

ment Services as part of its August 2026 index review.

The changes will take effect from the close of August 31, MSCI said. The India Domestic Index tracks Indian stocks selected under MSCI's methodology and is used by global investors to monitor segments of the Indian

equity market.

The review is part of MSCI's broader global index changes. At the global level, 55 securities will be added to and 92 deleted from the MSCI ACWI Index.

The MSCI ACWI Small Cap Index will see 203 additions and 261 deletions, while 184 securi-

ties will be added and 279 removed from the MSCI ACWI IMI.

The MSCI Emerging Markets Index will include additions such as Z.AI Co H, Nanya Technology and Guangdong Dtech Technology A. In the MSCI Frontier Markets Index, six securities will be added and five deleted.

SPORT

MORKEL SEES SKILL, VARIETY IN INDIA'S LEFT-ARM SPIN TRIO

India's got talent

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Galle, August 13

Bowling coach Morne Morkel on Thursday indicated that India could field three left-arm spinners in the upcoming first Test against Sri Lanka here, as Kuldeep Yadav, Manav Suthar and Ravindra Jadeja offer unmatched variety and wicket-taking skills.

Kuldeep bowls magic and mystic through his left-arm wrist spin, Jadeja's pinpoint accuracy can trouble even the best, but Suthar is a throwback to the days of loopy classical left-arm spin.

"Kuldeep is there, and he's the attacking sort of bowler and for us, his experience and class can't look past. So yeah, I think for us they're all different in their way," Morkel told the media here on Thursday.

"So one (Suthar) turns a bit more, one (Jadeja) is slightly more accurate and I don't think it's a (three left-arm spinners) massive concern for us. It's just how Gill is going to use those guys at certain times. But yeah, I mean in terms of skill they've got the skill to get the 20 wickets for us," he added.



India's players during a training session on Thursday

Morkel said India's spin line-up gave them a very attacking option, also considering the nature of the Galle pitch that may favour spin as the match progresses.

"Traditionally also if you look at the venue how it stacks and how it's been played up, that's sort of the way (three spinners) to go I think. The way we go with our spin bowling attack or spinners, it's a very attacking option.

"But looking at the surface, you know, to me, looks like a good surface, and I think as the Test goes on, you know, something will start to happen.

"So, we've prepared for all that can come our way, as it is more about the mental challenge in playing these conditions, batting time, bowling those spells and getting the ball in the right areas," he detailed.

Apart from the sea-

soned Siraj, India will have to take either Gurnoor Brar or Prasidh Krishna, who have limited Test experience, as support pacer.

Morkel said whoever gets the final nod – Prasidh or Brar – will be equal to the task. "I think it's exciting. They've played a lot of cricket back home where it's also tough bowling conditions, and I think coming here the biggest challenge will be the heat and humidity. The kook-

IN SHORT

» Kuldeep bowls magic and mystic through his left-arm wrist spin, Jadeja's pinpoint accuracy can trouble even the best

» Morkel said India's spin line-up gave them a very attacking option, also considering the nature of the Galle pitch that may favour spin

aburra ball...once it gets softer you know how we can stack up overs together with intensity and create that pressure. So, I'm quite excited about what I have seen over the last week or so, how these guys can stand up."

But beyond all these calculations, Morkel said, it is all about how the bowlers can sustain the intensity.

"It's all about your mindset. If you're a fast bowler, you know, the ball will go softer after 20-35 overs but then what is our next step? To be street-smart in terms of how we're going to use the crease? How are we going to use our short ball?"

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Galle, August 13

At times, cricketers make a particular stadium their favourite opera centre – churning out awe-inspiring performances one after another.

Mahela Jayawardene and Muttiah Muralitharan wrecked oppositions at Sinhalese Sports Club, Jacques Kallis' numbers at Newlands are beyond belief, while Stuart Broad at the Lord's was an unstoppable force.

Now, two Sri Lankan spinners – Prabath Jayasuriya and Ramesh Mendis – have made Galle International Cricket Stadium here their personal abattoir, running roughshod over rival batters.

Together, they have amassed 145 wickets at this venue – left-arm spinner Jayasuriya has plucked 81 wickets in a mere 11 Tests while off-spinner Mendis has taken 64 wickets in 12 matches here.

Former Sri Lankan cricketer Farvez Maharoof explained this unusual success rate.

"Prabath Jaysuriya is going to be the main



PRABATH JAYASURIYA AND RAMESH MENDIS HAVE MADE GALLE INTERNATIONAL CRICKET STADIUM THEIR PERSONAL ABATTOIR

destroyed India at their own backyard, and later off-spinner Simon Harmer of South Africa repeated the feat.

Now, the Indian batters will have to face a quality left-arm and off-spin combine in the same match.

Former Sri Lankan spinner Upul Chandana offered a word of caution.

"Jayasuriya has quickly become Sri Lanka's top spinner. He largely bowls in the conventional way, you know, he hardly gives any freedom to the batsmen. If the pitch has a different bounce on it, then his accuracy will be very helpful," says Chandana.

The former spinner offered the example of Jayasuriya, a discovery of former Lankan skipper Dimuth Karunaratne, getting rid of Pakistan batsman Babar Azam quite regularly.



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Galle, August 13

Dhruv Jurel was a picture of concentration in the nets at the sweltering Galle, middling almost everything that came his way from pacers and spin-

ners alike.

Prior to that, he was an active presence in the fielding practice session, taking some tumbling catches at the cordon. Jurel's enthusiasm actually belied the career cross-road that he is standing currently. After a

JUREL WAITS FOR SPINNERS TO ERR TO PUNISH THEM IN A RISK-FREE APPROACH

rather assured 100 against

the West Indies at Ahmedabad in October last year, his next Test outings have produced – 44, 6, 14, 13, 0, 2, 19.

More worryingly, he has been dismissed five times by spinners in those seven outings, and he will face an

even more daunting task in the first Test here against the Sri Lankan tweakers, led by the irrepressible Prabath Jayasuriya.

The inclusion of Sarfaraz Khan, who bats at the same slot as Jurel, is a warning for the wicket-

keeper batter to tidy up his act or get replaced.

Sarfaraz has a wider range of shots against spinners – sweep, reverse sweep, shimmy down the track mixed with those late dabs and cuts past the point or gully fielders.

Savita believes India have what it takes to finish on WC podium ‘Can match best teams in world’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA New Delhi, August 13

Seasoned goalkeeper Savita Punia believes India's FIH Nations Cup triumph has given the women's hockey team the confidence and belief to challenge the world's best and finish on the podium at the upcoming World Cup.



India head into the showpiece event on the back of their Nations Cup title, where they beat a competitive field to claim their first major international gold in a long time. “Winning the FIH Nations Cup was a big achievement because all the top teams were there. It was a competitive tournament, and coming out on top gave us a huge boost and winning a gold medal after a long time has lifted the team's morale and belief,” Savita told JioStar. The veteran feels India's performances against top sides in the FIH Pro League have also shown that the team is capable of competing with the best.

“In recent years, during the Pro League, we have played close matches against top sides like Argentina, Netherlands, and Germany. Those games showed us that we can match the best teams in the world,” she said.

“I can confidently say about this Indian women's hockey team that while all the teams are world-class, there is no team we cannot compete with. We have the skill, the fitness, and the mindset to challenge anyone on our day.”

India will open their World Cup campaign against China on August 16 before taking on South Africa and England in Pool D.

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice No. JHS-N-W72-26 Date: 12.08.2026
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works:
E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W72-26 Approx Cost : Rs. 7784355.18/-
Description of work : Provision of S&T work in connection with VGLJ-DHO-TSR(P)-70.576 TkM
Earnest Money : Rs. 155700/- Cost of Tender form : Nil
Opening of tender : 04.09.2026 Time 15:00
Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months
• Tender on line can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 04.09.2026. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S&T) 1870/26 (D)
North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mohd. Tufel S/o Mohd. Anwar, R/o House No. 283A, Phool Bagh Street, Rampur Katra, PS Sirauli, Rampur, Uttar Pradesh, Present Add.: A-93, Fana Manjil, Nizam Nagar Basti, Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 289/2024 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Mohd. Tufel cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Mohd. Tufel has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Mohd. Tufel of FIR No. 289/2024 U/S 33 Delhi Excise Act, PS Hazrat Nizamuddin, New Delhi is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of 16.09.2026 at 10:00 am.
By Order,
Sh. Manuj Kaushal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
South East District
Saket Court, New Delhi
DP/11179/SE/2026(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE No. 18/2026/RS/JHS Date: 10.08.2026
TENDER NOTICE
For and on behalf of President of India, the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (Rolling Stock) North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work:
Tender No.: JHS-RS-WC-T8-2026-27
Description: Replacement of overaged cable, repairing of trench/cable tray alongwith improvement of pit/light at ELS/JHS.
Tender value: Rs. 9064662.75 Earnest money: Rs. 181300.00
Completion period from the date of issue of LOA.: 12 Months
Closing date of tender: 08.09.2026, Tenderer will submit the tender online upto 08.09.2026 (15:00 Hrs.). Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website http://www.ireps.gov.in. 1854/26 (D)
North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 31.08.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 33,41,370/- (Rupees Thirty Three Lakh Forty One Thousand Three Hundred Seventy only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLRH000391811, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 28.07.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 29.07.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from the Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 9,10,000/- (Rupees Nine Lakh Ten Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 91,000/- (Rupees Ninety One Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
RESIDENTIAL FLAT NUMBER GF - 3, M. I. G., (GROUND FLOOR), HAVING A COVERED AREA OF 700 SQUARE FEET I. E. 65.03 SQUARE METERS, SITUATED AT PLOT NUMBER A - 47, BLOCK - A, COMPRISING OF KHASRA NUMBER 1278, IN "S. L. F. VED VIHAR", HADBAST VILLAGE LONI, DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH.
BOUNDED AS:-
EAST : PLOT NO. A-58 NORTH : FLAT NO. GF - 4 (M.I.G.)
WEST : COMMON PASSAGE SOUTH : PLOT NO. A-46
For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No: 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.
sd/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED
(Formerly known as INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)
Date : 10.08.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
L.No.: JHS-DyCEE-WS-T-01-2026-27 Date: 11.08.2026
TENDER NOTICE
For and on behalf of President of India, the Dy.CEE/WS/JHS, North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work:-
Tender No.: JHS-DyCEE-WS-T-01-2026-27
Description of work/Jhansi Workshop:- "Improvement in general lighting arrangement of wagon repair workshop Jhansi and its surrounding area."
Tender Value: Rs. 7102197/- Only (Seventy One Lakhs Two Thousand One Hundred Ninety Seven Only)
Bid Security: Rs. 142100/- Only (One Lakhs Forty Two Thousand One Hundred Only)
Completion period: 06 months
Closing date of tender: 07.09.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.).
Tenderer will submit the tender online upto 07.09.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.). Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website http://www.ireps.gov.in. 1871/26 (PH)
North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Amit Rajput S/o Vedram R/o WZA 370, A-Block, Tilak Nagar, Delhi, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under FIR No. 681/2020 U/s 129/55 IPC., has been registered at PS: Tilak Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, Amit Rajput cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Amit Rajput has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Amit Rajput under FIR No. 681/2020 U/s 129/55 IPC., registered at PS: Tilak Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 18.09.2026.
By Order
Sh. Vikas Madan
JMFC, Room No. 289
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/11240/WD/2026 (Court Notice)

INDIAN RAILWAYS
भारत सरकार GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
रेल मंत्रालय MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS
(रेलवे बोर्ड RAILWAY BOARD)
No.2026/RS(WTA)-149/Tender/569 New Delhi, Dated: 13/08/2026
Global e-Tender No WTA-569 opening on 29/09/2026 for procurement of Solid Forged Wheels (Rough Turned) for FIAT IR Bogies (LHB) to Drg.No.MI006615 Alt.-b.
Electronic bids are invited for and on behalf of the President of India for procurement of Solid Forged Wheels (Rough Turned) for FIAT IR Bogies (LHB) to Drg.No.MI006615 Alt.-b and Specification No. IRS R-19/93 Part-II (Rev.6) and RDSO Sketch-92114 Alt.11. The interested bidders are advised to visit the website http://ireps.gov.in for further details, downloading of the tender documents and submission of their e-bids. Any further corrigendum to this tender will be uploaded on the website http://ireps.gov.in only and not in print media.
DIRECTOR, RAILWAY STORES (M)
MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS (RAILWAY BOARD)
RAIL BHAWAN, RAISINA ROAD NEW DELHI-110001
Tel No.011-23073191, E-mail ID: drsm@rb.railnet.gov.in
2798/26 SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita
Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely Sheikh Hafizul S/o Sheik Rajabul R/o Juggi No. 415, CD Park, Jahangirpuri, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence under FIR No. 422/2020 U/s 380/411/454/34 IPC., has been registered at PS: Mahendra Park, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, Sheikh Hafizul cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, Sheikh Hafizul has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, Sheikh Hafizul of under FIR No. 422/2020 U/s 380/411/454/34 IPC., Registered at PS: Mahendra Park, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 13.10.2026.
By Order
Ms. Amardeep Kaur
ACJM (North), Room No. 117
Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/11128/NW/2026 (Court Notice)

ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
Corporate Office : Unit No. 502, C Wing, ONE BKC, Plot No. C - 66, G - Block, Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai - 400051. Tel : 022 68643101.
Registered Office : 14th Floor, EROS Corporate Tower, Nehru Place, New Delhi - 110019.
E-mail : acre.arc@acreinodia.in | Website : www.acreinodia.in | CIN : U65993DL2002PLC115769
APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. [CIN : U65993DL2002PLC115769] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 31.08.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 17,11,695/- (Rupees Seventeen Lakh Eleven Thousand Six Hundred Ninety Five only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDCP00278809, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 02.07.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 03.07.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from NARESH KUMAR and RAKESH KUMAR.
The Loan Account bearing No. HHLDCP00278809, along with all right(s), title(s), interest(s), underlying security(ies), pledge(s) and / or guarantee(s), including the Immovable Property, had been assigned by Sammaan Capital Limited ("SCL") (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) to Indiabulls Asset Reconstruction Co. Ltd. ("IARCL") vide Assignment Agreement dated 30.09.2020 and the same had been renumbered by IARCL and bears new Loan Account No N0010XVI. The said Loan Account had been further assigned by IARCL to and in favour of the Secured Creditor, acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 102 - Trust vide Assignment Agreement dated 26.04.2021 read rectification deed dated 26.08.2021. Furthermore, the said Loan Account has now been assigned by Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 102 - Trust to and in favour of the Secured Creditor acting as a Trustee of ACRE - 100 - Trust vide Assignment Agreement dated 23.06.2025.
The Reserve Price for the Immovable Property will be Rs. 20,10,000/- (Rupees Twenty Lakh Ten Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 2,01,000/- (Rupees Two Lakh One Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.
DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. C/1H - 238, HAVING SUPER AREA OF 585 SQUARE FEET ON 2ND FLOOR, IN TOWER - C, IN THE RESIDENTIAL COMPLEX KNOWN AS "URBAN HOMES - 1", SITUATED IN VILLAGE SHAPUR BAMTHA, PRAGNA DASANA, NATIONAL HIGHWAY - 24, TEHSIL AND DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201302, UTTAR PRADESH.
For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.acreinodia.in; Contact No: 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.
sd/-
AUTHORIZED OFFICER
ASSETS CARE & RECONSTRUCTION ENTERPRISE LTD.
TRUSTEE OF ACRE - 100 - TRUST
Place : GHAZIABAD
Date : 07.08.2026
"For any grievance you may contact Mr. Mohd Sharif Malik, Grievance Resolution Officer, Assets Care & Reconstruction Enterprise Ltd. The detailed policy on Grievance Redressal Mechanism within the organisation can be accessed at https://www.acreinodia.in/compliance".

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Procurement Tender Notice No. 27/2026 Dated: 12.08.2026
E-Procurement Tender Notice
On behalf of the President of India, Sr. Divisional Materials Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj invites the E-Procurement tenders:
S. Tender No. Description Qty. EMD (Rs.)
1 19256354B Electrically Operated Wind Screen Wiper 124 Set. 7,73,760/-
2 19266807 Main Transformer 7775 KVA Type 01 No. 2,21,210/-
Tender Opening Date: For S.No.: 1:- 02.09.2026 & For S.No. 2:- 08.09.2026
Note: (1) The complete information of above E-Procurement Tender is available on IREPS website i.e. http://www.ireps.gov.in (2) Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above Tender, for this purpose, Vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Class III digital Signature certificates issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. (3) Rates entered into financial rate page and duly signed digitally shall only be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendor shall be straight away ignored and shall not be considered. (4) Documents being attached should be signed on their body. The above tender notice has been uploaded on http://www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in". In case of any difficulty helpdesk available on the IREPS website may be approached. 1866/26 (MG)
North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

WEST CENTRAL RAILWAY
OPEN TENDER NOTICE
No. EL/50/NIT/101 (2026-27) Date : 24.07.2026
Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (General), West Central Railway, Kota for and on behalf of President of Union of India invites E-tender for following works.
Tender No.: EL/50/329R/2026-27, Description of work : Kota Division: Provision of Track Machine siding with facilities (11 Station - JHW, RDT, ALNI, LKE, URM, SNAR, THEA, MLGH, PSLI, MXL, FSP), KOTA-COR Section - Improvement of TTM siding at Bundi and MLGH station and Upgradation /renovation of TTM Rest House at BUDI and MLGH, Providing New Office Building for CMI, TI, ARME & USFD etc on replacement basis at SGZ station and provision of New Trade union Office on replacement basis at SGZ & VMA Station and Providing to Subordinate Rest House SGZ & TTM Rest House at CMU, VMA & Improvement / Repairs to SRH/TTM Rest House at MEP under ADEN/SGZ., Approx. cost of the work (In Rs.): 1,12,46,340.61, Earnest Money (In Rs.): 2,24,900/-, Completion period: 09 Months, Date & Time of submission and opening: submission upto 07.09.2026 upto 15.00 hrs. and opening at 15.15 hrs. The offer is accepted only through E-Tendering on website http://www.ireps.gov.in / The bidders should have class III digital signature certificate and must be registered on IREPS portal. No tender is accepted manually. Please read tender terms & conditions before the tendering (sd).
By Sr. Div. Elect. Engineer (General)
West Central Railway, Kota
सहकार काल अभियान एक कदम स्वच्छता की ओर
EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Open Tender
For and or behalf of the India invited e-open tender (E-Tender Notice no: CW-Sonpur-14-2026) from experienced contractor for the work given below :- 1. Name of the work with its location : Electrical Maintenance of coaches at BUJ Depot under SEE division for three years. 2. Approx. cost of the work: Rs. 1,20,02,566.25/- (Rs. One Crore Twenty Lakh Two Thousand Five Hundred Sixty-Six and Twenty-Five Paise only). 3. Earnest Money to be deposited : Rs. 2,40,100.00/- (Rs. Two Lakh Forty-Thousand One Hundred only). 4. Date & time for submission of tender and opening of tender : Tender submission date & time: Up to 15.00 Hrs. dated : 02-09-2026 Opening date & time: After 15.00 Hrs., dated : 02-09-2026. 5. Website particulars notice board location where complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender can be purchased etc.: Website:- https://www.ireps.gov.in. Railway administration reserves the right to postponed/ modify or to cancel the tender any time without assigning any reasons. ADME/C&W/SEE
PR0726/SEE/MECH/T/26-27/36

S. E. RAILWAY - TENDER
Tender Notice No. TRD-KGP-W-2026-27-21 Dated 11.08.2026. For and on behalf of President of India, the Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRD/Kharagpur-721301 invites e-tender for the following works before 15:00 hrs. on the date mentioned against items and will be opened at 15:30 hrs. Description of works : Electrical/TRD for the work of DANSI (ph)-Conversion of DANSI (PH) into Block station having 2 loop lines. Tender Value: ₹ 1,21,03,358.84. EMD: ₹ 2,42,100/- Cost of tender document : Nil. Date of Opening: 04.09.2026. Completion Period: 18 months. Date of Submission: upto 15:00 hrs. of 04.09.2026. Interested Tenderers may visit website www.ireps.gov.in for full details, description, specification of the tender and submit their bids online. In no case manual tender for this work will be accepted. Note: Prospective bidders may regularly visit www.ireps.gov.in to participate in all tenders. (PR-609)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-Tendering Tender Notice
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.
E-Tender No. : JHS-ENG-G-2026-185 Approx Cost : 19973930.50
Description of work : Construction of Soak pits/RWH at TBT, BZY, BAB, MXS, DWA, Orai, PHN, & BZM under Sr. DEN/Central jurisdiction.
Earnest Money : 399600.00 Date of closing Tender : 07.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 10 Months.
• Tender online can be submitted upto 15:00 hrs on 07.09.2026 • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1861/26 (C)
North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPRONC

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(SEE SECTION 82 (2) (ii) Cr.P.C.)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) Ranjbir Singh M/s Gloomy Health Care Pvt. Ltd. At: C-2/17, Arjun Marg, DL City-1, Gurugram, Haryana and M/s Satayam Medicare Hospital At: C-2/17, Arjun Marg, DL City-1, Gurugram, Haryana has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CC NI Act 4088/2023, U/s NI Act, PS Sangam Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) Ranjbir Singh cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) Ranjbir Singh has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) Ranjbir Singh of case CC NI Act 4088/2023, U/s NI Act, PS Sangam Vihar, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated 05.10.2026.
By Order
Ms. Pooja Kumari
DP/11101/SD/2026 JMFC (NI Act) 10, South Distt.
(Court Matter) Court No. 25, Saket Court, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Sanno J S/o Munshi Singh R/o B-530 Gola Kuan Tehkhand Village, Okhla Phase-1, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 325/2020 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT & 5/180 MV ACT, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Sanno J cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Sanno J has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that Sanno J in FIR No. 325/2020 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT & 5/180 MV ACT, PS Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.09.2026.
By order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
South East Room No. 513
Saket Court Complex, New Delhi
DP/11200/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.PC. /84 BNSS
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, Bitoo, S/o: Shiv Udgar, R/o: E-65, J.J. Colony, Sec-24, Rohini, Budh Vihar, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No.: 01136/2023, U/s: 379/411 IPC, registered at P.S.: Budh Vihar, Delhi, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, Bitoo, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, Bitoo, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, Bitoo, FIR No.:01136/2023, U/s: 379/411 IPC, registered at P.S.: Budh Vihar, Delhi, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.09.2026.
By Order
Sanyam Jain
Judicial Magistrate First Class-04
North West, Room No. 112,
Rohini Courts, Delhi
DP/11308/RD/2026 (Court Matter)

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF Sh. Sukhbir Civil Judge (Junior Division), Bhiwani
Raj Kumar and ORS. Vs. M/S SUNRAYS HEIGHTS PRIVATE LIMITED
CS-936-2026
CNR No. HRBH02-001538-2026
Next Date: 09.09.2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: GENERAL PUBLIC
In above titled case, the defendant(s)/respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 09-09-2026 at 10:00 a.m. For details login to https://highcourthd.gov.in/?mod= district notice & district =Bhiwani
Sd/- Ms. Meeta Kohli
Additional Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani
Dated 11-08-2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement Systems)
N.I.T. No. 22, 24, 25, 26 & 28-2026-27-WV
Name of work with its location : 22. Replacement of ballast retainer with RCC slab in connection with increasing the speed potential to ease the curve at Br.No.5/(1X3.05m), 32/(1X6.10m), 59/(7X6.10m) & 89/(3X6.10m) on Delhi-Rewari (DLI-RE) section. Similar nature of work :- Construction of any bridge work.
24. Cess repair at various loactions on JNC-PWL section under ADEN/TKD. Similar nature of work :- Any civil engineering work involving earth work in banks/cutting.
25. Cess repair at various loactions on DLI-RE under ADEN/DDEE in the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN-VDLI. Similar nature of work :- Any civil engineering work involving earth work in banks/cutting.
26. Repair of the sand hump at GGN, GHF, PT, JSKA, PTRD, IHP and KIP (11 No.s) under Section Under SSE/M/SGN under ADEN/DDEE in the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN-VDLI. Similar nature of work :- Any Civil work other than track work.
28. Repair of the sand hump at OKA,LPNR,DSJ,BRSQ,HNZM (05 No.s) and other allied works under Section SSE/M/NZM under ADEN/NZM in the jurisdiction of Sr.DEN-VDLI. (Based on DSR). Similar nature of work :- Any Civil work other than track work.
Approx Cost of Work 22. Rs. 37696387.11 24. Rs. 24276395.79 25. Rs. 24320216.79 26. Rs. 22575375.93 28. Rs. 23227761.41
Earnest Money Deposit (It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no. 201025/CE-I/CT/51 Dated 31.08.2016)
22. Rs. 753900.00 24. Rs. 485500.00 25. Rs. 486400.00
26. Rs. 451500.00 28. Rs. 464600.00
Completion Period of Work 22, 06 Months 24, 12 Months 25, 12 Months 26, 06 Months 28, 06 Months
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender Upto 15:00 hrs. on 07.09.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. On 07.09.2026.
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc. Above tender for available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No. 128-W/280/OET/2026-27-W/V-NIT-22, 24, 25, 26 & 28-2026-27 Date: 11.08.2026 2794/2026 SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited
Regd. & Corp. office : 1101, Sharda Terraces, Plot 65, Sector - 11, CBD Belapur, Navi Mumbai - 400614. CIN: L65923MH2008PLC261472.
POSSESSION NOTICE
Whereas The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of the M/s. Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd., under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (ACT NO.54 OF 2002) and in exercise of powers conferred under section 14(2) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued a demand notice to below mentioned Borrower/s / Guarantor/s. After completion of 60 days from date of receipt of the said notice, the Borrower/s / Guarantor/s having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower/s / Guarantor/s and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on them under section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 6 & 6 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on the date mentioned herewith:-
Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor Date of Demand Notice 14.05.2026
237000000005 & 237000000006, 1) MR. INTEKHAB ALAM, S/O FAKRE ALAM 2) MRS. NAHID PRAVEEN W/O INTEKHAB ALAM
Total Outstanding Amount in Rs. Rs. 93,15,066.44/- as on 07.05.2026
Date of Possession 12.08.2026(Symbolic)
Description of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (ies) : ALL THAT PIECE AND PARCELS OF UNIT NO.1C, PLOT NO. C-660, GROUND FLOOR, NEW FRIENDS COLONY, NEW DELHI-110025, TOTAL AREA 800 SQ. FT. BOUNDARIES : EAST : 15 WIDE SERVICE LANE, SOUTH: PLOT NO.661, WEST: 80 WIDE ROAD, NORTH: TOT LOT
Name of Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Guarantor Date of Demand Notice 22.05.2026
257000032627 & 256000009110, 1) M/S B & M CONSTRUCTIONS AND DEVELOPMENTS PRIVATE LIMITED, 2) MR. DEVENDRA PANDEY S/O M.M. PANDEY 3) MR. PRABHA SHANKAR SINGH S/O LAKSHMAN SINGH S/O MRS. MINI SINGH W/O PRABHA SHANKAR SINGH
Total Outstanding Amount in Rs. Rs.6,35,67,957.94/- as on 13.05.2026 & 20.05.2026
Date of Possession 12.08.2026(Symbolic)
Description of Secured Asset(S) /Immovable Property (ies) : RESIDENTIAL UNIT BEARING NO. A-014, COMPRISING OF BASEMENT, GROUND FLOOR, FIRST FLOOR, SECOND FLOOR, & TERRACE HAVING GT BUILT-UP AREA MEASURING 3155 SQ. FT. (APPROX) BUILT ON PLOT NO. 014, ADMEASURING AREA 224.95 SQ. MTR. IN BLOCK NO. A, IN THE RESIDENTIAL COMPLEX KNOWN AS "INTERNATIONAL CITY" SITUATED AT SECTOR 106, 108 AND 109 TEHSIL GURGAON DISTRICT GURGAON HARYANA. BOUNDEREIS:- EAST: PLOT NO. 12M, WEST: OTHER PLOT, NORTH: VILLA NO. A - 12A, SOUTH: VILLA NO. A - 15
The Borrower/s / Guarantor/s in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of the M/s Suryoday Small Finance Bank Ltd, for an above mentioned demanded amount and further interest thereon.
Date : 14.08.2026, Place : Delhi NCR Authorised Officer, Suryoday Small Finance Bank Limited

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
No. AGC-EL-C-T-02-2026-27 Date: 11.08.2026
E-Tender Notice
Dy. Chief Electrical Engineer (Const.), North Central Railway, Agra for and behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through on line only (E-Tendering) for the following works:
Tender No. AGC-EL-C-T-02-2026-27 Bid Security: As per IREPS
Name of work with its location: Electrification of various services buildings (Bateshawar), newly constructed Platforms at Bateshawar, Approach Road, etc. at Various Location in Connection with the Conversion of 'D' Class station to 'B' Class station at BASR, work of Agra Division of North Central Railway
Approx. Cost of the work: ₹ 78,11,714.94
Completion Period: 06 Months from the date of issue of acceptance letter including monsoon period.
Tender closing date & time: 02.09.2026 upto 15:00 hrs.
Validity of offer: 60 days from the date of tender opening.
Tenderers can only submit their offer through web portal www.ireps.gov.in up to 15:00 hrs on 02.09.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 1859/26(AK)
North central railways @ CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in



Preity hopes to reunite with Aamir

Zinta is currently busy promoting her upcoming film 'Batwara 1947'

Farhan Akhtar's directorial debut 'Dil Chahta Hai' completed 25 years this month, marking a major milestone for the much-loved film that went on to become one of the defining movies of its generation.

As the film completed 25 years, actress Preity Zinta, who is currently busy promoting her upcoming film 'Batwara 1947', opened up about missing the anniversary celebrations.

Speaking to the media, Preity jok-

AS 'DIL CHAHTA HAI' COMPLETED 25 YEARS, SHE OPENED UP ABOUT MISSING THE ANNIVERSARY CELEBRATIONS

ingly pointed out that she had to choose between the promotions of her comeback film and the 'Dil Chahta Hai' reunion with Aamir Khan. Recalling the situation, the actress said, "I would have liked to share a lot of memories. But Aamir ne hi batwara kar diya humara. I had to come for the 'Batwara'

promotions and they went for the 25 years of 'Dil Chahta Hai'."

The actress also shared that she is looking forward to sharing screen space with Aamir again. She also reflected on the lasting impact of 'Dil Chahta Hai' and expressed hope that their next collaboration will be just as memorable.

"So, I'm really looking forward to working with him again, hopefully, on another film that becomes just as memorable. 'Dil Chahta Hai' was truly a memorable film. 'Batwara 1947' is also going to be a memorable film." AGENCIES

Alden Ehrenreich joins cast of 'Miami Vice '85'

It's directed by Joseph Kosinski from a screenplay by Dan Gilroy

Alden Ehrenreich is set to join Michael B Jordan and Austin Butler in Universal Pictures' upcoming action drama 'Miami Vice '85', a new take on the classic 1980s television series. Directed by Joseph Kosinski from a screenplay by Dan Gilroy, the film will explore the glamour and corruption of mid-1980s Miami.

'Miami Vice '85' is inspired by the pilot episode of the landmark 'Universal Television' series, which became a cultural phenomenon and influenced everything from fashion to filmmaking. The new film will be shot for IMAX and is scheduled to be released on May 19, 2028, with production set to begin later this year.

The film is produced by Dylan Clark through 'Dylan Clark Productions' and Kosinski. Gilroy's screenplay is based on characters created by Anthony Yerkovich from the original



series, which was executive produced by Yerkovich and Michael Mann. Eric Warren Singer previously worked on an earlier draft of the screenplay.

For Ehrenreich, the role comes after his first Tony Award win earlier this year for his performance in 'Becky Shaw'. The actor's upcoming projects also include Anton Corbijn's 'A Talent for Murder', in which he stars opposite Helen Mirren and which will premiere at the 2026 Toronto International Film Festival. PTI

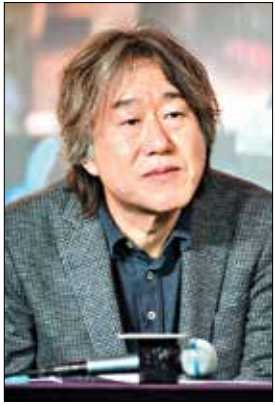
Korean director Ahn Pan Seok dies at 64

He was known for helming several acclaimed romance dramas

Korean director Ahn Pan Seok has died at the age of 64 after battling a cerebral haemorrhage. He was known for helming several acclaimed romance dramas, including 'Behind the White Tower', 'Something in the Rain', 'One Spring Night' and 'The Midnight Romance in Hagwon'. The news was shared by the makers of his upcoming drama 'Romance Expert', starring Choo Young Woo and Kim So Hyun.

On August 12, the production team of ENA's 'Romance Expert' released an official statement announcing his death. It read, "We are heartbroken to share this tragic news. Director Ahn Pan Seok passed away on August 12, 2026, at the age of 64."

The statement further read, "We are sharing this news at the request of the bereaved family. As the family is currently in deep grief and wishes to have a quiet farewell with the deceased, we sincerely ask for your cooperation in keeping the funeral proceedings private from the press. Once again, we express our deepest condolences. May he rest in peace."



HE MADE HIS DIRECTORIAL DEBUT IN 1994 WITH 'GREETINGS OF LOVE'

Last month, it was reported that Ahn Pan Seok had collapsed due to a cerebral haemorrhage and was hospitalised for treatment. At the time, the production company said, "He is currently recovering. Following the completion of filming, the editing work has also been completed."

Ahn Pan Seok began his career in the entertainment industry in 1987 as a producer in MBC's drama department. He made his directorial debut in 1994 with MBC Best Theatre's 'Greetings of Love'. AGENCIES

DHURANDHAR: THE REVENGE

'Aditya was confident no abuses would be beeped'

When 'Dhurandhar: The Revenge' arrived in theatres earlier this year, one of the casting choices that caught viewers by surprise was Suvinder Vicky, who played the father of Arjun Rampal's character in Aditya Dhar's revenge epic. While his appearance in the film was brief, his character became a talking point because his limited screen time was marked by a series of abusive exchanges directed at his on-screen son.

In a new interview, Suvinder spoke about his dialogue in the film and how Dhar was confident that nothing would get beeped out by the censors.

In a conversation with 'Hindustan Times', Suvinder reflected on the role and the lan-



guage used for his character. The actor credited the director for the way the character was conceived, while also acknowledging the effort he brought to the part. "I'm lucky to work with great directors. In this, the credit goes to Aditya Dhar and to me also because I also gave my hundred per cent effort. Also, the credit for all the abusive language would also go to our screenwriter," he said. AGENCIES

PARTITION HORRORS

REMEMBRANCE DAY

14 August, 2026

A day to remember one of humanity's greatest tragedies and honour the memory of the irreparable loss, pain, and trauma endured by the victims and survivors of partition

“Partition Horrors Remembrance Day is a reminder of our enduring responsibility to strengthen the bonds of harmony that hold our country together.”

-Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Special observance programs in honour of partition victims on 14 August, 2026

Time: 3:00 pm onwards
Venue: Golden Jubilee Auditorium, GNDU, Amritsar, Punjab

Time: 5:00 pm onwards
Venue: Central Park, Connaught Place, New Delhi

Time: 4:30 pm onwards
Venue: New Town Convention Centre, Kolkata, West Bengal

On this day, let us endeavour to strengthen our commitment to oneness and inspire future generations with the values of peace, compassion and social harmony

Let us participate in nationwide tributes:

Candlelight Marches

Plays on the Theme of Partition

Exhibitions on Partition

Educational Seminars

For more information visit : amritkaal.nic.in | Scan this QR

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